

TEN TOES DOWN PRESENTS / THE TELLINGS CUT

# The Panorama of Games for Lillian

VOLUME 4 OF SIX

## The Casino Locked My Champagne in a Puzzle

*Puzzles, mechanisms, creative toys and retro desktop diversions*

Forty real games. Aiden has made it everybody's problem.

Adult comic edition: reclaimed in-group language, profanity, fictional cocaine references and sexual innuendo.

New ChatGPT prose under Nolan's creative direction.

Tellings Cut 2.0 - 20 September 2026

**240 CASES / SIX DEPARTMENTS**

ZERO OBLIGATION TO OBEY THE DEPARTMENTS

## How to find a game in this book

Each game starts with a short pitch, what you actually do, the controls and pace, the main catch, and a first action to try. These practical sections use plain language. The longer Aiden scene comes after them.

For a fast comparison, read the pitch and main catch on two or three pages. Use the alphabetical index to jump to a title. Choose the full story only when you want the comedy; it is never a prerequisite for understanding the game.

This is an original comic game catalogue inspired by the Aiden ensemble in Ten Toes Down. The source novels remain separate. Game descriptions and catches are research-based editorial notes; Aiden's ministry and rulings are fiction.

The catalogue ranges across possible fits and clearly marked detours. "Waits" describes the usual decision loop, not a certification that every scene is untimed. The labels mean: A place to start = a promising candidate; Read the catch first = a meaningful obstacle needs checking; A more demanding detour = a narrower or harder option. They describe the game, not the reader. Check the exact edition.

Choose any game directly. Skip any game for any reason. The elaborate route is an optional joke; declining never costs a token. No purchase, download, account or medical information is needed to use this book.

Print on Letter paper at actual size, or fit to A4. Page references use volume / page, which remain valid in the omnibus. For larger type, use the reflowable EPUB. Links and a full alphabetical index sit beside the printed case numbers.

### The six departments

1. Suspiciously Interesting People - mysteries and adventures
2. Taking One's Turn - strategy and role-playing
3. Looking Around Before Doing Anything - exploration
4. Things That Fit Into Other Things - puzzles and construction
5. People Who Have Something to Tell You - character stories
6. Bringing a Friend - co-op and shared play

# Choose a game by its name

This is the quick route. Click any title, or turn to its page. Read the short pitch and main catch first; Aiden's scene follows the practical guide. The case number works across every format.

|      |                                                      |    |      |                                              |    |
|------|------------------------------------------------------|----|------|----------------------------------------------|----|
| P126 | <a href="#">A Good Snowman Is Hard To Build</a>      | 12 | P149 | <a href="#">Return of the Obra Dinn</a>      | 51 |
| P128 | <a href="#">A Monster's Expedition</a>               | 15 | P158 | <a href="#">RollerCoaster Tycoon Deluxe</a>  | 69 |
| P121 | <a href="#">Baba Is You</a>                          | 6  | P157 | <a href="#">SimCity 2000 Special Edition</a> | 67 |
| P129 | <a href="#">Bonfire Peaks</a>                        | 16 | P124 | <a href="#">Snakebird</a>                    | 10 |
| P131 | <a href="#">Braid, Anniversary Edition</a>           | 20 | P125 | <a href="#">Snakebird Primer</a>             | 11 |
| P130 | <a href="#">Can of Wormholes</a>                     | 17 | P151 | <a href="#">Sokobond</a>                     | 56 |
| P146 | <a href="#">Carto</a>                                | 45 | P123 | <a href="#">Stephen's Sausage Roll</a>       | 8  |
| P147 | <a href="#">Chants of Sennaar</a>                    | 47 | P153 | <a href="#">Tametsi</a>                      | 60 |
| P135 | <a href="#">COCOON</a>                               | 26 | P143 | <a href="#">The House of Da Vinci</a>        | 39 |
| P155 | <a href="#">Color a Dinosaur</a>                     | 64 | P144 | <a href="#">The House of Da Vinci 2</a>      | 41 |
| P127 | <a href="#">Cosmic Express</a>                       | 14 | P145 | <a href="#">The House of Da Vinci 3</a>      | 43 |
| P136 | <a href="#">Gorogoa</a>                              | 28 | P156 | <a href="#">The Incredible Machine 3</a>     | 65 |
| P148 | <a href="#">Heaven's Vault</a>                       | 49 | P139 | <a href="#">The Room</a>                     | 32 |
| P152 | <a href="#">Hexcells</a>                             | 58 | P142 | <a href="#">The Room 4: Old Sins</a>         | 38 |
| P134 | <a href="#">HUMANITY</a>                             | 25 | P141 | <a href="#">The Room Three</a>               | 36 |
| P154 | <a href="#">Mario Paint</a>                          | 62 | P140 | <a href="#">The Room Two</a>                 | 34 |
| P138 | <a href="#">Monument Valley 2: Panoramic Edition</a> | 30 | P159 | <a href="#">Theme Hospital</a>               | 71 |
| P137 | <a href="#">Monument Valley: Panoramic Edition</a>   | 29 | P132 | <a href="#">World of Goo</a>                 | 22 |
| P150 | <a href="#">Opus Magnum</a>                          | 53 | P133 | <a href="#">World of Goo 2</a>               | 23 |
| P122 | <a href="#">Patrick's Parabox</a>                    | 7  | P160 | <a href="#">Zoombinis</a>                    | 73 |

# A route that knows when to shut up

## The shortest working procedure

First name up to three real preferences or vetoes: required speed, camera movement, holds, menus, reading, clue tracking or native co-op. Keep them beside you. The route cannot overrule them.

You are in Department 4. Pick one mood row and one emblem column below; neither claims to describe a game feature. That gives a starting case. You can go there now.

For ceremonial excess only, roll four ordinary six-sided dice: 1-2 means minus one; 3-4 means zero; 5-6 means plus one. Add the four results. Add zero, one or two for any already-available wanted drink and wanted snack. Eating is never required.

Begin a browsing session with three imaginary Stamp Tokens. At most once per selection, spend one to add two OR reroll all four dice. You may take an optional funny trait from Book I as your excuse. Never pay a token to refuse a game.

Move that many cases along this department's forty-case shelf, wrapping around at either end. Read the real catch. If you want one appeal, visit the adjacent case or the same local position in another department; then choose freely or stop. No appeal loops.

The printed full rules, worked example and incident desk are in Volume I. The offline index performs the arithmetic and provides conservative evidence filters. The direct alphabetical index near the front always works without dice.

| Mood / emblem                 | 1. Envelope | 2. Key | 3. Plant | 4. Map | 5. Teacup | 6. Spare chair | 7. Gold stamp | 8. Clock |
|-------------------------------|-------------|--------|----------|--------|-----------|----------------|---------------|----------|
| 1. Quietly curious            | P121        | P122   | P123     | P124   | P125      | P126           | P127          | P128     |
| 2. Ready for conversation     | P129        | P130   | P131     | P132   | P133      | P134           | P135          | P136     |
| 3. Willing to inspect a thing | P137        | P138   | P139     | P140   | P141      | P142           | P143          | P144     |
| 4. Here for the atmosphere    | P145        | P146   | P147     | P148   | P149      | P150           | P151          | P152     |
| 5. Open to a wildcard         | P153        | P154   | P155     | P156   | P157      | P158           | P159          | P160     |

Local position =  $8 \times (\text{row} - 1) + \text{emblem}$ . Wrap modified position to 1-40. Global case =  $40 \times (\text{department} - 1) + \text{local position}$ .

## The Box Cost More Than What Was Inside It

'Nigga, open my champagne.' The host smiled and touched a brass dial. Nothing opened. I touched the invoice. The amount had opened parts of my nervous system I preferred to keep private. Tank walked around the carved box, looked for a hinge and asked whether the bottle knew it was in prison. The host said we were about to embark on an unforgettable journey. Shawna said the journey had already missed its dinner reservation.

The casino's lower lounge had been transformed for our second set of games. Not a paper office in sight. Marble tables. Velvet chairs. A chandelier so low Dre had ducked once and then taken personal offense. Little machines, strange pictures, locked compartments and an entire miniature city that somebody thought I could be trusted to govern. Mercedes read the sign over the door: THE INTELLECTUAL EXPERIENCE. 'Nigga,' she said, 'that phrase never comes before a reasonable bill.'

Rosa had just finished singing. She wanted food, a chair and a game she could choose without attending a lecture. Tank could supply advice about the first two. Shawna wanted to know what each game actually asked a person to do. Porsche had the hotel manager's number and was prepared to use it against anything that interfered with these modest ambitions. I wanted the locked bottle to open in a way that made the room applaud. Four separate projects had arrived in one suit.

Dre placed his casserole beside the miniature city and claimed a blue chair. 'Crip zoning,' he said. Mercedes moved the chair out of the walking route. 'Crip still gotta leave a path to the bathroom.' He looked at the space, nodded and moved his dish with him. The city's first planning dispute ended with everybody able to reach the toilet. I considered borrowing the technique for the actual hotel.

Darnell had found a new audience near the mechanical box. He mentioned cocaine, then the yacht, then a woman who had allegedly said the yacht was the best part of knowing him. 'Nigga, you telling that like a compliment?' Tank asked. Darnell clarified that she had admired its size. Shawna touched my arm before I could contribute. 'Don't.' The restraint nearly injured me. Mercedes moved Rosa's chair away from the story and toward the game she wanted to try.

The host finally explained the box. Look closely. Notice the moving part. Follow what changed. We could do that. Then he added a dramatic flourish about genius. Shawna held up a hand. 'Leave that bit out.' I objected because genius had been the part I intended to supply. She kissed me and said I could be sexy without turning every hinge into an intelligence contest. Tank asked whether that offer extended to all the niggas or whether marriage provided exclusive licensing. We began with one object. Mercedes found a detail. Rosa moved the lamp. Dre kept Darnell from balancing a drink on the mechanism. I followed a connection and heard a clean little click. Something opened. The satisfaction hit before I could market it. For a second I was simply glad to understand what the thing wanted from my hands.

Inside sat another box. Tank stared at it. 'Nigga, the champagne has a gated community.' The host smiled. Shawna laughed and pulled me into the chair beside hers. We had plenty of other choices on the tables. Nobody had to finish the box to earn a pleasant evening. I accepted that principle with considerable maturity, then asked the waiter to bring an ordinary bottle with an ordinary fucking cork.

## P121 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

# Baba Is You

Edition considered: PC release

**Discover puzzles where moving the words changes the rules, if a small action leading to a big conceptual surprise appeals.**

**What you do.** Move around compact boards, push rule words into new arrangements and observe how the changed rules affect the puzzle.

Direction + buttons | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

**Main catch.** The simple movement system supports difficult reasoning; verify movement repeat, undo and exact controls before choosing it.

**Why it might click.** Baba Is You turns the rules of a puzzle into objects you can move. A short arrangement of words can transform what a wall, flag or character does. The appeal is the surprise of realizing that the rule you assumed was fixed is actually the thing to manipulate.

**The full catch.** The small number of movement actions should not be confused with easy reasoning. The developer describes a large collection of increasingly inventive rule interactions. Reading the words, predicting consequences and revising a plan can become demanding. Check the exact movement, undo and restart controls rather than assuming they are comfortable because the board is compact.

**Try this first.** Try an introductory level and deliberately move one rule word. Observe what changes before attempting a long solution or consulting an entire set of hints.

## AIDEN AFTER HOURS / The Sign Said Aiden Is King Until My Wife Moved a Word

I hired a light-up sign for the casino lounge. AIDEN IS KING. Three separate panels, because even my modesty required modular construction.

Shawna moved one. KING IS AIDEN became AIDEN IS EXTRA when Mercedes found the rental company's spare lettering.

Tank laughed so hard he put his plate down. Nigga made room for the joke.

I tried to restore order. Porsche moved the KING panel over the buffet. Suddenly every adult in the room agreed with the new constitution.

The funny part was how little had changed physically. Same pieces. Different rule. My magnificent authority had become something anybody could push around.

'That's dangerous,' I said. 'For who?' my wife asked.

I kissed her and offered to negotiate a private monarchy upstairs. She turned the EXTRA panel toward me.

'Room service extra. Champagne extra. You? Nigga, consistently extra.'

I left the sign alone. For once the room's rules described its actual government.

**Aiden's verdict.** Pick the rule-changing puzzle if rearranging an idea sounds exciting. The controls can be small while the reasoning grows enormous, as my dismantled monarchy demonstrates.

## Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Exact-title developer/publisher Steam description inspected for premise and edition. Fit and first trial are editorial suggestions. Controls, timing and comfort remain bounded by the explicit checks in the card; no complete playthrough performed.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/736260/>

## P122 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

# Patrick's Parabox

Edition considered: PC release

**Explore boxes within boxes, if discovering how nested spaces fit together sounds more interesting than following a conventional character story.**

**What you do.** Move pieces through recursive box arrangements, reconsider the spatial relationships and try new paths through the compact puzzle.

Direction + buttons | Usually waits for choices | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

**Main catch.** The developer declares untimed input, but nested relationships can create substantial reasoning and memory demands.

**Why it might click.** Patrick's Parabox explores boxes that contain other boxes, including recursive arrangements. The repeated act of pushing gains new meaning as the space folds into itself. Its interest is in discovering how a small set of relationships can support surprisingly rich puzzles.

**The full catch.** The current Steam listing declares play without timed input and keyboard-only support. Spatial nesting can still require holding several relationships in mind even when the controls are limited. Verify key repeat, undo and any zoom behavior in the actual version. There is little conventional character story to carry the experience if the recursive logic itself does not appeal.

**Try this first.** Play the earliest introduction to entering and leaving a box. Explain one relationship aloud if useful, then try a move that tests that explanation.

## AIDEN AFTER HOURS / The VIP Room Was Inside Another VIP Room I Wasn't Allowed In

The casino sold me a private room inside a private room. I assumed this was the highest level of importance a man could rent without purchasing a small country.

At the inner door, the attendant asked for another wristband.

'Nigga, I'm the reason the outer room exists.' 'This is the inner experience, sir.'

Tank looked through the glass. 'They got the same shrimp.'

Shawna took the floor plan. Rooms inside rooms, each apparently promising to make the last one feel ordinary. Mercedes asked where the nesting stopped. The attendant smiled with the confidence of a man paid by the boundary.

I imagined pushing the whole inner room into the outer one. A satisfying little rearrangement. The hierarchy might fit differently.

Porsche opened a side door and found the two rooms shared a kitchen. Tank walked straight through it.

'Nigga, recursion has a buffet entrance.'

I followed my wife. We reached the center without upgrading our identities.

**Aiden's verdict.** Choose recursive box puzzles if nested spaces make you curious. The developer declares untimed input, but remembering how the layers relate remains the central challenge.

## Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Exact Steam developer description supports premise. Current developer declarations include Playable without Timed Input and Keyboard Only Option. Physical comfort, held inputs and reasoning load still need their stated checks; this is not a hands-on completion test.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1260520/>

P123 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

# Stephen's Sausage Roll

Edition considered: PC release

**Work through compact spatial puzzles built around a comic cooking premise, if figuring out a demanding arrangement sounds satisfying.**

**What you do.** Inspect the puzzle space, move through its arrangement and test how your actions change the problem in front of you.

Direction + buttons | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

**Main catch.** The primary description is brief; controls and full-game timing remain unresolved, and the reasoning can be demanding.

**Why it might click.** Stephen's Sausage Roll is a compact three-dimensional puzzle game built around unusually exact spatial problems. Its appeal is the satisfaction of understanding a small arrangement deeply enough to make it work. It belongs on the reasoning shelf for someone who enjoys a stubborn little mechanism more than an expansive story.

**The full catch.** The inspected primary storefront supplies very little detailed control information, so this card does not certify timing, holds or the full interaction set. The title's cheerful food premise should not imply easy puzzles. Treat both input comfort and the amount of planning as questions for an early trial, with no expectation of quick completion.

**Try this first.** Inspect the first small puzzle and test a single movement. If the rules interest you, try one hypothesis; if they merely irritate, leave the plate unfinished.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

## P123 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

# Stephen's Sausage Roll

**AIDEN AFTER HOURS / The Sausage Chef Asked Me to Stop Talking About My Equipment**

The late buffet included a man grilling elaborate sausages. I watched him turn one and told Shawna he reminded me of a certain gifted husband.

She looked at the grill. 'Nigga, that one's burnt.'

Tank choked on a laugh. The chef kept working with the concentration of somebody who had heard every version of my joke and preferred his tongs.

I tried to recover by discussing technique. Mercedes asked what qualified me. 'Natural understanding of impressive meat.'

The chef handed me a plate. Empty. 'Hold this.'

I stood there while a small cooking problem received actual attention. Placement. Turning. The consequence of a careless move. Simple objects could create a serious puzzle without accepting my commentary.

Shawna finally took the plate from me. 'Good job, baby. You kept that part level.'

Dre applauded beside Tank. 'My Crip casserole got more experience than this nigga.'

The chef served my wife first. I respected the man's survival instinct.

**Aiden's verdict.** Try the compact puzzle if demanding spatial logic appeals. The brief source description leaves control details unresolved; the sausage jokes provide no evidence of mechanical simplicity.

**Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026**

Exact-game Steam description is very brief ('A simple 3d puzzle game'); source supports identity and basic genre, not detailed control or difficulty certification. Scene is original fiction. Specific input and full-game timing remain to be checked.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/353540/>

## P124 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

# Snakebird

Edition considered: PC original game

**Guide an awkward growing creature through spatial puzzles, if planning around its shape sounds like an enjoyable challenge to explore.**

**What you do.** Move the creature through a puzzle arrangement and account for how its changing shape affects the possible route.

Direction + buttons | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

**Main catch.** The developer calls the puzzles challenging; colorful creatures and limited controls do not establish easy reasoning.

**Why it might click.** Snakebird makes the length and shape of its fruit-eating creatures central to spatial puzzles. What looks like a small comic animal becomes a tool for crossing, supporting and arranging a route. The attraction is the way a simple change in body length changes the whole problem.

**The full catch.** The developer explicitly calls the game deceptively challenging. A friendly drawing and a small board should not be sold as easy reasoning. Check directional input, switching between creatures and recovery from mistakes. The card does not establish universal no-timing behavior from genre alone; its strongest case is for a player who enjoys concentrated spatial experimentation.

**Try this first.** Try the earliest fruit-and-exit arrangement. Notice what the new length permits before attempting to plan several moves ahead.

## AIDEN AFTER HOURS / The Feather Boa Ate the Whole Dance Floor

Porsche's costume started as a feather collar. Every time somebody complimented it, she added another length. By midnight it stretched across two chairs and one unfortunate man's drink.

I told her more was always better. Shawna looked at my event invoice and declined to endorse the theory.

Tank tried to pass behind the boa. It followed him. 'Nigga, this bird got a trailer.'

We worked out how to move the ridiculous growing shape around the furniture. One turn solved a problem and created another. Mercedes lifted the end while Rosa rescued the drink.

I liked watching the room become a spatial question. I liked it less when the boa wrapped around my ankle.

'Don't panic,' Porsche said. 'I'm expensive,' I replied. 'That's not the same thing.'

Shawna freed me and kissed the top of my head. Tank told everybody the king had been defeated by accessories.

Porsche added another feather. Nigga, the creature was still feeding.

**Aiden's verdict.** Choose the bird puzzle if planning around an awkward growing shape sounds satisfying. Its bright appearance does not cancel the developer's warning about serious difficulty.

## Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Exact-title developer/publisher Steam description inspected for premise and edition. Fit and first trial are editorial suggestions. Controls, timing and comfort remain bounded by the explicit checks in the card; no complete playthrough performed.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/357300/>

## P125 / A PLACE TO START

# Snakebird Primer

Edition considered: PC separate prequel game

**Try a gentler introduction to Snakebird's spatial idea, if a clearer opening challenge makes discovering its rules more appealing.**

**What you do.** Work through the separate Primer game's introductory puzzles, moving the creature and learning how its shape affects each route.

Direction + buttons | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

**Main catch.** This is the easier separate game, not a guarantee of effortless puzzles; movement and undo still need checking.

**Why it might click.** Snakebird Primer is a separate set of puzzles designed as a more approachable introduction to Snakebird's spatial ideas. The developer explicitly contrasts its easier island with the original game's serious challenges. It can be a useful place to discover whether moving and shaping these creatures is pleasurable before choosing the harder title.

**The full catch.** Easier is a comparison, not a personal guarantee. Directional movement, visual planning and keeping track of a changing shape still matter. Check undo, restart and control repetition in the exact release. The appeal remains puzzle logic rather than rich character dialogue, and a player need not graduate to the original game to justify enjoying this one.

**Try this first.** Complete or explore one introductory arrangement, focusing on how fruit changes the creature. Let curiosity about the next idea decide whether to continue.

## AIDEN AFTER HOURS / The Small Feather Boa Was Allowed to Attend Orientation

After the full feather disaster, Rosa cut a short strip from the costume supplies and put it on the table. 'Start with this.'

I objected to the reduced spectacle. Tank held up his stained sleeve. 'Nigga, spectacle already had a turn.'

Shawna arranged three glasses around the small boa. We worked out a route through them. Mercedes changed one thing and asked whether the same idea still worked.

It did not. Good. We could see why without losing the entire dance floor.

I stopped insisting that the first exercise resemble the grand finale. There was pleasure in recognizing a rule clearly enough to use it somewhere new.

Porsche watched us, then placed one extra glass in the way. 'Now do it while your reputation watching.'

Tank moved his chair closer. 'I'm his reputation. I ain't been impressed in years.'

My wife solved the little arrangement and slid it toward me. 'Your turn, big nigga. No cape required.'

**Aiden's verdict.** Start with Primer if the spatial idea appeals and a gentler introduction is wanted. A smaller opening challenge can still lead to worthwhile thinking without demanding spectacle.

## Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Exact-title developer/publisher Steam description inspected for premise and edition. Fit and first trial are editorial suggestions. Controls, timing and comfort remain bounded by the explicit checks in the card; no complete playthrough performed.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1014140/>

P126 / A PLACE TO START

# A Good Snowman Is Hard To Build

Edition considered: PC release

**Make charming snowmen through compact spatial puzzles, if arranging a small scene is enough motivation to think through a problem.**

**What you do.** Move around each small space and manipulate snowballs to find an arrangement that makes the intended snowman work.

Direction + buttons | Usually waits for choices | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

**Main catch.** Untimed and keyboard-only declarations help, but exact movement, holding and planning demands remain worth checking.

**Why it might click.** A Good Snowman Is Hard To Build makes a small, affectionate premise into a spatial puzzle: a monster creating snowmen. The compact scenes invite attention to a few objects and how their positions relate. It can offer a satisfying repeated activity without needing a sprawling world or a dense inventory story.

**The full catch.** The current developer listing declares play without timed input and keyboard-only support. Check movement, undo and snowball manipulation on the chosen device; those declarations do not establish that every action avoids holding. The puzzles still require planning and trial, so the gentle presentation should not become a promise of effortless solutions. Narrative is limited to the charm of the activity.

**Try this first.** Try making one snowman and notice where your first plan changes. Learn the recovery control before treating a mistaken move as a reason to restart everything.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

## P126 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

# A Good Snowman Is Hard To Build

**AIDEN AFTER HOURS / The Snowman Got Better Treatment Than the Guest of Honor**

The casino installed an ice sculpture beside the bar. Three round sections. A charming face. I asked whether it could be made to resemble me.

The sculptor looked at the middle section. Tank said, 'Nigga, careful how you answer.'

Shawna adjusted its scarf. Rosa moved the spotlight so the face looked warm instead of interrogated. Mercedes put a little flower beside it. Suddenly everybody liked the snowman.

I asked what I had to do to receive this level of care. 'Stand still and stop narrating yourself,' my wife said.

The sculptor showed us how one small adjustment changed the whole figure. Not more ornament. Better arrangement.

I tried a dignified silence. Tank timed it with a sip of water. I lasted until somebody called the sculpture handsome.

'Nigga, we share a jawline.'

Shawna kissed my cheek. 'There he is. Couldn't let frozen water have one compliment.'

The snowman kept smiling. Tough competition.

**Aiden's verdict.** Choose the snowman puzzles if making a compact arrangement work sounds charming. Untimed-input support helps, while planning and exact movement still deserve a practical check.

**Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026**

Exact Steam developer description supports premise. Current developer declarations include Playable without Timed Input and Keyboard Only Option. Physical comfort, held inputs and reasoning load still need their stated checks; this is not a hands-on completion test.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/316610/>

## P127 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

# Cosmic Express

Edition considered: PC release

**Design a tiny railway for unusual passengers, if finding a route within tight space and capacity limits sounds satisfying.**

**What you do.** Draw or arrange tracks through the station so the train can collect and deliver its passengers in a workable order.

Mouse / pointer | Usually waits for choices | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

**Main catch.** The puzzles are explicitly difficult; test track input despite declared untimed play and keyboard-only or mouse-only options.

**Why it might click.** Cosmic Express asks you to lay railway routes through small space stations and deliver their residents. The one-passenger constraint makes the order of visits important. Its appeal is the clean relationship between a visible route and the consequences that follow from it.

**The full catch.** The developer describes the puzzles as difficult and separately declares play without timed input, with keyboard-only and mouse-only options. Drawing tracks may still involve sustained pointer actions, so test the intended input method. Cute passengers do not reduce the planning burden: a compact station can hold a demanding puzzle. The declared input options do not certify hold-free interaction.

**Try this first.** Draw a route in an early station and watch one passenger's trip. Test editing or resetting the route before trying to optimize a complicated arrangement.

## AIDEN AFTER HOURS / The Private Train Had Room for One Nigga and His Confidence

I rented a novelty train to carry guests across the casino terrace. The carriage seated one adult. Tank read the sign and looked at me.

'Nigga, that's a chair with a railway problem.'

I volunteered to demonstrate. Shawna asked where the train would put everybody else while I enjoyed transportation. I pointed to the route. Mercedes pointed to the queue forming beside it.

The little system had a real constraint. One passenger. A path. Somebody waiting at the next stop. My desire to be admired did not create another seat.

Rosa moved a table so the train could reach the far side. Porsche adjusted the order of stops. The ridiculous thing began to make sense.

I offered Shawna the first ride. She sat, crossed her legs, and waved like royalty.

Tank leaned toward me. 'See? Nigga finally built public transport for the public.'

I walked alongside. She took my hand when the train stopped, which improved its passenger capacity emotionally.

**Aiden's verdict.** Choose the railway puzzle if routing within tight limits sounds satisfying. It can wait for thought, but the track controls and difficult planning still need checking.

## Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Exact Steam developer description supports premise. Current developer declarations include Playable without Timed Input and Keyboard Only Option plus Mouse Only Option. Physical comfort, held inputs and reasoning load still need their stated checks; this is not a hands-on completion test.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/583270/>

## P128 / A PLACE TO START

# A Monster's Expedition

Edition considered: PC release

**Explore a playful museum of human oddities through spatial puzzles, with discoveries and jokes giving the journey a welcoming purpose.**

**What you do.** Explore the islands, solve environmental arrangements and investigate exhibits that offer an unusual outside view of human habits.

Direction + buttons | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

**Main catch.** The charm accompanies real spatial reasoning, while movement, undo and object manipulation still need checking.

**Why it might click.** A Monster's Expedition combines tree-pushing spatial puzzles with comic museum observations about humanity. Small islands form a larger exploratory structure, so solving a route can lead to both a new place and a new joke. It offers a particular mix of thoughtful manipulation and dry amusement.

**The full catch.** The developer describes simple mechanics with substantial depth. That depth can mean difficult planning even when the action vocabulary is small. Check movement, undo, reset and the readability of the islands and exhibits. Its open structure should not be treated as proof that every puzzle is optional or that every route remains easy.

**Try this first.** Solve or experiment with one early crossing, then read the nearby exhibit. Judge whether the combination of puzzle and joke makes you want another island.

## AIDEN AFTER HOURS / The Museum Called My Underwear a Ceremonial Flag

The hotel displayed old celebrity belongings near the lounge. Porsche slipped one of my spare silk boxers into an empty frame and wrote ROYAL BATTLE STANDARD beneath it.

Tank bent over laughing. 'Nigga fought bravely in these.'

Shawna read the label. 'Short campaign.'

I demanded historical accuracy. Mercedes asked whether I wanted the underwear returned or the explanation corrected. Important distinction. I wanted both and a more flattering font.

A small crowd of adult guests gathered. Nobody knew exactly what they were looking at, but the confident label had done impressive work. Rosa said museums could make ordinary things wonderfully strange.

I admitted that an outside view of our habits might be funny as hell. Then a guest offered to buy the frame.

I considered the offer. My wife removed the garment before I could turn married life into a collectible. 'Private collection, nigga.'

Tank asked whether the museum gift shop sold the longer campaign.

**Aiden's verdict.** Choose the exploratory puzzles if a funny outside view of human habits appeals. The museum's charm supports the journey, while the physical puzzle controls still need testing.

## Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Exact-title developer/publisher Steam description inspected for premise and edition. Fit and first trial are editorial suggestions. Controls, timing and comfort remain bounded by the explicit checks in the card; no complete playthrough performed.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1052990/>

## P129 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

# Bonfire Peaks

Edition considered: PC release

**Work through spatial puzzles with a reflective theme of carrying and letting go, if that combination feels intriguing to you.**

**What you do.** Move through puzzle spaces, arrange what you carry and examine how the next position changes the problem's possibilities.

Direction + buttons | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

**Main catch.** Its voxel spaces can be demanding to reason about; exact controls and full-game timing still need checking.

**Why it might click.** Bonfire Peaks presents a spatial puzzle journey organized around closure and moving onward. Its compact, sculptural environments make objects and their placement visually central. It may appeal when the satisfaction of an exact arrangement is strengthened by a quiet theme about what people carry.

**The full catch.** The primary description promises rewarding challenges and evolving mechanics, not low difficulty. Manipulating objects in three-dimensional puzzle spaces may require careful orientation and planning. Check the actual movement and object controls before assuming the fixed-looking presentation eliminates physical demands. The emotional theme is suggestive rather than a richly voiced character drama.

**Try this first.** Inspect an early puzzle, learn one object interaction and test how to recover from a mistake. Continue only if the precise arrangement feels absorbing rather than burdensome.

## AIDEN AFTER HOURS / The Bonfire Was Supposed to Burn My Old Speeches

The hotel offered a ceremonial fire bowl. I brought a stack of unused speeches. Shawna looked impressed until she saw I'd printed replacements.

'Nigga, that ain't letting go. That's inventory rotation.'

Tank brought a broken party sign. Mercedes brought nothing and said she didn't owe the evening a symbolic sacrifice. Rosa wanted the flame kept away from her dress. All sensible agendas except mine.

I held one speech over the bowl and recognized an entire paragraph about how humble I had become. The paper deserved better than another audience.

I let it go.

Nobody applauded. That helped. The small act stayed mine instead of becoming a performance I'd need to preserve.

Then the manager asked who had ordered the fire feature. Tank pointed at me.

'Additional charge, sir.' I looked at the remaining speeches. 'Nigga, letting go expensive.'

Shawna took my hand. 'Still cheaper than making us hear them.'

**Aiden's verdict.** Try the spatial puzzle if its idea of carrying and relinquishing things appeals. The reflective mood accompanies demanding arrangements; it does not make every solution easy.

## Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Exact-title developer/publisher Steam description inspected for premise and edition. Fit and first trial are editorial suggestions. Controls, timing and comfort remain bounded by the explicit checks in the card; no complete playthrough performed.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1147890/>

P130 / A PLACE TO START

# Can of Wormholes

Edition considered: PC release

**Explore a deep puzzle world with hints you can play, if learning through a smaller demonstration sounds more enjoyable than reading explanations.**

**What you do.** Move through the puzzle situations, experiment with solutions and use playable hints to discover the underlying ideas when needed.

Direction + buttons | Usually waits for choices | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

**Main catch.** Explicit untimed input and unlimited undo are helpful; deeper reasoning and device-specific control comfort still matter.

**Why it might click.** Can of Wormholes develops many interactions from a small collection of puzzle objects. Its distinctive strength for this catalogue is a documented playable hint system: a smaller related stage can suggest the insight needed for the larger one. Experimentation and discovery are the main rewards.

**The full catch.** The developer explicitly states that no time-critical inputs or simultaneous key presses are required, and documents unlimited undo and restart. Those are unusually useful concrete claims. Keyboard or gamepad play is supported, with a Mac gamepad limitation noted by the developer. Spatial reasoning and learning new interactions can still be demanding; hold behavior should be checked separately.

**Try this first.** Try an introductory stage, use undo once and inspect a playable hint if curiosity stalls. Learn how the support works before a difficult puzzle makes it feel urgent.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

## P130 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

# Can of Wormholes

**AIDEN AFTER HOURS / The Hint Was a Smaller Disaster I Could Actually Understand**

I asked the cocktail-table puzzle host for help. He began a lecture. Tank stopped him. 'Nigga, show him one thing before his ego orders another drink.'

The host made a tiny version of the arrangement. One moving part. One consequence. I tried it and immediately saw what I'd been missing.

Shawna watched my face. 'There. You don't need to be embarrassed every time learning happens.'

I said I had never been embarrassed. Mercedes pointed to the jacket I was wearing indoors because I'd spilled champagne down the shirt.

The little demonstration did not solve the whole problem for me. It gave me a useful idea. I went back to the larger arrangement and changed one thing.

It worked. Tank lifted his glass. 'My nigga discovered assistance.'

I prepared to explain the significance of this breakthrough. Rosa slid the small puzzle back in front of me.

'Try the version with fewer words.'

My wife laughed. Excellent hint system. Brutal delivery.

**Aiden's verdict.** Start here if learning through playable hints sounds appealing. Explicitly untimed inputs and unrestricted undo are useful evidence, while the puzzle's deeper reasoning remains the attraction.

**Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026**

Developer Steam description explicitly says no time-critical input or simultaneous key presses, unlimited undo/restart and playable hints; gamepad on Mac is not currently supported in that description. This supports the stated narrow timing claims, not universal hold-free operation.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1295320/>

## The Cocktail Did Not Need an Optimization Score

The mechanical drinks display completed a full cycle without colliding with itself. The bartender tasted the result and nodded. I asked whether it could be done faster. Mercedes said, 'Nigga, taste the drink before you improve its employment conditions.'

I tasted it. Good. The little arms moved again. That steady repeat had a pleasure of its own. I wanted to enjoy it and also wanted a plaque declaring that nobody had ever arranged a better beverage. Shawna could see both ambitions fighting across my face. She moved the imaginary plaque off the table before it became another actual expense.

Darnell leaned over and said his yacht had a faster system. Rosa asked him what music he liked. He returned to the yacht. Mercedes took his empty glass. 'You need a second subject, nigga. Cocaine already used up the first one's vocabulary.' Dre offered him casserole. For several blessed seconds chewing slowed the marine infrastructure report.

A working solution could be enough. A clever arrangement could be satisfying before comparison turned it into labor. That did not mean every puzzle was easy, or that a quiet screen asked little from a person. The point was to want the thing being asked. A small move. A difficult inference. A story clue. Whatever sounded good when nobody was announcing your performance.

I took Shawna's hand and asked whether my romantic technique required optimization. She looked at the untouched ordinary champagne. 'Start with being here.' Tank raised his glass. 'Best feedback the nigga got all night.' I remained present with a degree of concentration that would have impressed any machine on the table.

## P131 / A MORE DEMANDING DETOUR

# Braid, Anniversary Edition

Edition considered: PC Anniversary Edition

**Explore platform puzzles that manipulate time, if clever movement challenges are appealing enough to accept their physical and timing demands.**

**What you do.** Move through platforming spaces and use the game's time-manipulation ideas to reconsider routes, mistakes and puzzle solutions.

Direction + buttons | Action continues while you think | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

**Main catch.** Rewinding does not remove timed jumps or other platforming demands, so this remains an action detour.

**Why it might click.** Braid, Anniversary Edition combines platform movement with puzzles built around unusual behavior of time. Its story and images concern memory, desire and regret. The new edition also includes extensive creator commentary, offering another route into the design for someone interested in how a game thinks.

**The full catch.** Rewinding does not remove jumping, hazards or required movement timing. The developer explicitly describes platforming and changing time mechanics. This is a conditional action-puzzle detour, not a standard no-rush fit. Check movement, jump combinations and rewind holds separately; a forgiving recovery system can reduce failure cost without reducing the action itself.

**Try this first.** Try one introductory movement puzzle and the rewind control. If the physical action is unwelcome, consider the design commentary as an interest to investigate rather than forcing play.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

## P131 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

# Braid, Anniversary Edition

**AIDEN AFTER HOURS / I Wanted to Rewind the Part Where I Said Watch This**

I told the room I could step from the low platform to the velvet bench without spilling my drink. Shawna said the sentence already contained too many projects.

'Watch this, baby.' Tank watched. Mercedes watched. Rosa moved her microphone away from the likely splash zone.

I reached the bench. My drink reached the carpet. My dignity stayed somewhere between them asking for a return ticket.

Somebody played the security camera clip backward on a phone. Champagne leapt into the glass. I floated gracefully back to the platform. Every nigga cheered.

'See?' I said. 'Beautiful movement.'

Shawna took the phone. 'Rewinding doesn't mean you didn't need to land.'

I could appreciate a clever relationship with time without volunteering to repeat the physical demand. I sat beside her and let the clip finish.

Tank watched it forward once more. 'Nigga invented regret with a replay function.'

My wife put a dry drink in my hand. Ground level. Very advanced.

**Aiden's verdict.** Keep the time-manipulation platformer as a deliberate action detour. Rewinding a mistake can be clever without removing the timed movement that caused it in the first place.

**Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026**

Exact-title developer/publisher Steam description inspected for premise and edition. Fit and first trial are editorial suggestions. Controls, timing and comfort remain bounded by the explicit checks in the card; no complete playthrough performed.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/499180/>

## P132 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

# World of Goo

Edition considered: PC original game

**Build unusual structures from connected creatures, if watching a physical construction succeed or wobble sounds like the pleasure you want.**

**What you do.** Place and connect the available pieces, observe how the structure behaves and revise the arrangement when it fails.

Mouse / pointer | Some real-time demands | Co-op details need checking

**Main catch.** Physics, precision and dragging can add pressure or sustained input; inspect the chosen level and controls directly.

**Why it might click.** World of Goo turns drag-and-drop construction into a physics puzzle with a comic corporate world around it. Structures bend, balance and fail in visible ways, so a small design change can be satisfying to test. Its personality comes from the creatures, signs and increasingly strange purposes of the construction work.

**The full catch.** The primary description explicitly says drag and drop. Holding and positioning the pointer may therefore be a central barrier. Physics unfolds while structures are running, and hazards vary by level, so do not assume an unlimited-waiting solution from the word puzzle. Check the ordinary building loop before becoming invested in the larger campaign.

**Try this first.** Build the smallest useful connection in an early level and watch it behave. Test selecting, dragging and releasing one piece before attempting an elaborate tower.

## AIDEN AFTER HOURS / The Bridge Was Made of Candy and My Reputation

The dessert chef built a little bridge from sticky sweets. I announced that it could support a champagne flute. He said it was decoration. I heard opportunity.

Tank looked at the span. 'Nigga, even the candy scared.'

Mercedes held the glass while Shawna moved the supports. We could see the problem shift when one piece changed. That was interesting. My original demonstration plan was mostly expensive gravity.

A man from the VIP room offered engineering advice at extraordinary speed. Porsche asked if the cocaine had issued him a degree. He stopped pointing and sat down.

The chef added one sensible connection. The bridge steadied. I wanted to take credit, but my wife still had the glass and therefore controlled the evidence.

She put it safely on the table instead.

'We learned enough,' she said.

Tank ate one unused sweet. 'Bridge closed for consumption.'

I watched the structure lean. Nigga had found an entirely different failure mode.

**Aiden's verdict.** Choose the construction puzzle if experimenting with a wobbling structure sounds fun. Physics and dragging remain real demands, whatever impressive theory the party invents around them.

## Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Exact-title developer/publisher Steam description inspected for premise and edition. Fit and first trial are editorial suggestions. Controls, timing and comfort remain bounded by the explicit checks in the card; no complete playthrough performed.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/22000/>

## P133 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

# World of Goo 2

Edition considered: PC sequel

**Try new construction and liquid puzzles within World of Goo's satirical world, if experimenting with physical systems sounds entertaining.**

**What you do.** Arrange the available elements, observe their physical behavior and revise the construction to make the current situation work.

Mouse / pointer | Some real-time demands | Co-op details need checking

**Main catch.** New physical systems can increase demands; check pointer precision, dragging and scene-specific timing before treating it as relaxed.

**Why it might click.** World of Goo 2 expands the construction idea with flowing liquid, new material behaviors and another satirical corporate story. The attraction is watching a designed structure interact with a physical process, then discovering a better arrangement. It is a distinct sequel with new puzzles rather than an alternative edition of the first game.

**The full catch.** The developer describes a dangerous world and varied material mechanics. Pointer precision, holding or dragging, moving liquid and level-specific hazards need assessment. Do not assume that familiarity with one type of goo makes the complete game mechanically simple. This is most plausible when hands-on construction is itself enjoyable, not merely a route to the jokes.

**Try this first.** Try one early construction problem and observe how one material behaves. Check whether editing the structure feels comfortable before attempting to manage several interactions at once.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

## P133 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

# World of Goo 2

**AIDEN AFTER HOURS / The Green Company Had Painted the Spill Green**

The event sponsor called its new drinks fountain sustainable. A leak spread under the sign while the representative explained the future of responsible luxury.

Tank looked down. 'Nigga, the future wet.'

I asked what made the system green. The representative pointed at the green lights. Mercedes laughed so suddenly she startled him.

Shawna moved the power lead clear. Rosa rescued her shoes. Porsche brought towels. While the speech continued, the people without microphones solved the practical problem.

The mess did have an intriguing shape. Liquid taking the route the room gave it. A system behaving honestly beneath a dishonest advertisement.

I stopped the representative long enough to ask where the drain went. He looked offended by the question's lack of vision.

Tank handed him a towel. 'Here, my nigga. Participate in the circular economy.'

The man knelt. The speech ended. The floor began improving.

I considered hiring him for every future announcement, provided the towel remained part of the uniform.

**Aiden's verdict.** Try the sequel if its new construction and liquid ideas appeal. More physical systems can also mean more control demands; a green label does not simplify them.

**Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026**

Exact-title developer/publisher Steam description inspected for premise and edition. Fit and first trial are editorial suggestions. Controls, timing and comfort remain bounded by the explicit checks in the card; no complete playthrough performed.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/3385670/>

## P134 / A MORE DEMANDING DETOUR

## HUMANITY

Edition considered: PC non-VR mode proposed for assessment

**Direct striking crowds through puzzle spaces as a dog, if the unusual spectacle appeals alongside more active stages and challenges.**

**What you do.** Guide crowds through environments, place or use directions and respond to the puzzle and action situations along the route.

Mixed controls | Action continues while you think | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

**Main catch.** Action, platforming and bosses are documented, so the crowd-routing premise does not make the whole game untimed.

**Why it might click.** HUMANITY turns crowd direction into a striking puzzle-action spectacle. A dog places commands that shape the movement of many people, making routes and group behavior visible at a large scale. Its visual ideas may appeal to someone who enjoys watching a small instruction transform a complex scene.

**The full catch.** The developer explicitly includes action-focused stages, platform-like elements and boss battles. This prevents an unqualified no-rush recommendation. Navigation, command placement and the behavior of moving crowds need checking, and the ordinary-screen version should be assessed separately from VR. A clever planning premise does not remove required reactions elsewhere.

**Try this first.** Inspect an introductory routing stage and test one command. Treat later action sections as a real selection barrier, not a detail to discover after making a commitment.

## AIDEN AFTER HOURS / The Dog Took Over the Dance Floor

I spent fifteen minutes arranging the guests for a photograph. A little dog walked through the open door and solved crowd movement in six seconds.

Every adult followed it. 'Niggas, I'm the host.'

The dog stopped by Tank. Tank had chicken. The political situation was immediately clear.

Mercedes watched the crowd curve around tables. Shawna moved a chair before somebody tripped. Rosa laughed and asked why my seating plan had never inspired that kind of obedience.

I tried holding up a piece of bread. Nobody came. My campaign lacked protein.

Watching a crowd respond to simple direction was fascinating. Controlling the whole procession would be another matter, especially if the furniture changed while it moved.

The dog's owner collected it, thanked Tank and left. Everyone drifted back to their seats.

I stepped onto the platform. Shawna raised one finger. 'Before you speak, baby, ask whether the dog available for management consulting.'

Tank barked once. Traitor.

**Aiden's verdict.** Keep the crowd puzzle as an action detour. Its striking premise includes platforming and bosses, so a clever-looking procession is not evidence of fully relaxed play.

## Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Exact-title developer/publisher Steam description inspected for premise and edition. Fit and first trial are editorial suggestions. Controls, timing and comfort remain bounded by the explicit checks in the card; no complete playthrough performed.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1581480/>

## P135 / A MORE DEMANDING DETOUR

# COCOON

Edition considered: PC release

**Explore worlds nested inside portable worlds, if that spatial invention is compelling enough to consider a game with guardian encounters.**

**What you do.** Carry and use world-orbs, move between their environments and work out how the nested spaces relate to each other.

Direction + buttons | Some real-time demands | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

**Main catch.** Guardian battles are a concrete action barrier; also check movement and world-handling controls before committing to the journey.

**Why it might click.** COCOON builds an alien puzzle adventure around worlds contained within portable orbs. Carrying a world into another world changes what can be done, creating a strong visual form of discovery. The appeal is the elegant connection between an object, a place and a new possibility.

**The full catch.** The official description explicitly includes guardian battles with new mechanics. A small-looking action vocabulary therefore does not prove a no-reaction experience. Check movement, aiming or triggering abilities, required timing and the effect of failure. This is a narrow puzzle-adventure detour for someone interested in those interactions, not a default quiet-game recommendation.

**Try this first.** Try the first world-and-orb interaction to see whether its logic feels satisfying. Preview a representative guardian encounter before assuming that the opening describes the full game.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

## P135 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

## COCOON

## AIDEN AFTER HOURS / The Party Was Inside a Ball Inside Another Party

The designer hung mirrored spheres over the tables. Each one reflected the party differently. I looked into the nearest and found a tiny magnificent version of myself.

Tank leaned beside me. 'Nigga, even little you taking up space.'

Porsche opened one sphere to reveal a smaller lit room inside. A miniature lounge, a miniature bar, a miniature man who looked suspiciously overdressed.

Mercedes said the nesting was the interesting part. What happened in one space might change the way another space made sense. I said the tiny man needed a better suit.

Shawna put the sphere back before I could renovate him.

A sponsor in the next room started shouting about the evening's big challenge. Rosa rolled her eyes. 'Every pretty thing got somebody trying to turn it into a contest.'

I liked the tiny worlds. I did not need to pretend their beauty erased every hard encounter around them.

Tank tapped the outer sphere. 'Nigga in there probably wants a quiet table too.'

**Aiden's verdict.** Consider the nested-world puzzle for its spatial invention, with guardian battles explicitly in view. Beautiful miniature worlds do not cancel the action demands between them.

**Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026**

Exact-title developer/publisher Steam description inspected for premise and edition. Fit and first trial are editorial suggestions. Controls, timing and comfort remain bounded by the explicit checks in the card; no complete playthrough performed.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1497440/>

## P136 / A PLACE TO START

# Gorogoa

Edition considered: PC release

**Discover surprising connections between illustrated panels, if rearranging pictures into something newly meaningful sounds like a satisfying kind of puzzle.**

**What you do.** Move or arrange illustrated panels, inspect their details and follow the relationships that emerge when images connect differently.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

**Main catch.** Panel dragging and exact pointer control need checking; visual calm does not establish hold-free interaction.

**Why it might click.** Gorogoa tells its story through illustrated panels that the player arranges and combines. Its puzzles depend on visual relationships, scale and the possibility that one image can become part of another. The result can feel like discovering how a picture thinks rather than manipulating a conventional inventory.

**The full catch.** Panel movement and visual precision are the main checks. The store supports arranging and combining images, but not a complete hold-free control claim. Inspect whether dragging, zooming or small targets are comfortable on the chosen device. The story is largely visual and interpretive, which may be appealing or may feel less concrete than dialogue-led mysteries.

**Try this first.** Move or inspect one panel in the opening arrangement and watch for a new relationship. Focus on that single change before trying to explain the whole story.

## AIDEN AFTER HOURS / The Wedding Picture Opened onto the Wrong Reception

I ordered four large photographs for the lounge wall. The installers swapped two, and suddenly a doorway in one picture seemed to open into another.

Mercedes stopped them before they corrected it. 'Leave that a second.'

Shawna tilted a frame. A line connected. The room inside one image seemed to continue somewhere impossible. Tank leaned close enough to leave a nose print.

'Nigga, I can see a buffet through the marriage.'

The pleasure arrived before anybody explained it. One arrangement changed what the pictures could suggest. I moved the frame slightly, and the little illusion vanished. Moved it back. There.

Porsche asked whether I'd planned the effect. I opened my mouth. My wife pinched my sleeve.

'Tell the truth, baby. It's attractive.' I admitted the accident. Mercedes smiled and adjusted the final frame.

Tank studied the completed wall. 'Beautiful. Now put the real reception where that imaginary food is.'

Some niggas respect art most when it points toward dinner.

**Aiden's verdict.** Choose the image puzzle if discovering relationships between pictures sounds delightful. Check panel manipulation and dragging first; the visual revelation should be the pleasure, not the pointer struggle.

## Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Exact-title developer/publisher Steam description inspected for premise and edition. Fit and first trial are editorial suggestions. Controls, timing and comfort remain bounded by the explicit checks in the card; no complete playthrough performed.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/557600/>

## P137 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

# Monument Valley: Panoramic Edition

Edition considered: PC Panoramic Edition

**Explore impossible-looking architecture through a visual puzzle journey, if changing perspective and opening a path sounds appealing to you.**

**What you do.** Inspect each architectural scene and manipulate its structures to create a route through the changing arrangement of shapes.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

**Main catch.** Pushing, pulling and clicking need a hold-and-drag check on this PC edition, despite its approachable presentation.

**Why it might click.** Monument Valley guides Ida through compact architectural illusions. Manipulating parts of the monuments changes which paths connect, giving visual discovery a clear purpose. The Panoramic PC presentation can suit someone drawn to beautiful, contained spaces rather than a freely steered open world.

**The full catch.** The developer describes pushing, pulling, clicking, raising and lowering parts of the scenery. Those operations need a hold-and-drag check; the game's approachable marketing is not a control guarantee. The current Steam header uses Monument Valley, while its description explicitly identifies the Panoramic edition. Keep that edition scope when checking settings and input.

**Try this first.** Complete one early architectural transformation and send Ida along the new path. Test the manipulation itself before deciding that the quiet presentation matches the desired physical comfort.

## AIDEN AFTER HOURS / The Staircase Had Been Designed by a Nigga Who Hated Feet

The hotel art director built a staircase backdrop that appeared to lead in three directions at once. I stood beneath it and announced that our event had transcended ordinary architecture.

Shawna looked around. 'Where the actual stairs?'

Tank pointed at the service door. 'Architecture over there. Bullshit here.'

Mercedes shifted her viewpoint and watched the impossible shape become convincing. I liked the trick: a little change in how you looked could make a path appear.

Then I tried posing as if I were climbing it. My foot hit painted canvas. Porsche caught my sleeve before transcendence became a dental claim.

'Nigga, use your eyes first.'

I did. From the correct place, the picture worked beautifully. My body did not need to enter every beautiful idea.

Shawna took the photograph. In it I looked like I owned a palace that had defeated gravity.

Out of frame, Tank held me steady and asked what architectural consultants earned.

**Aiden's verdict.** Try the architectural illusion if changing a view sounds satisfying. Its pushing and pulling need a hold-and-drag check before the peaceful appearance earns your trust.

## Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Manually inspected correct Steam app 1927720. Current header shortens the name, but detailed description explicitly identifies Panoramic Edition and manipulation actions. Wrong or unresolved automatic cache excluded. Holds/timing not certified.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1927720/>

P138 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

# Monument Valley 2: Panoramic Edition

Edition considered: PC Panoramic Edition

**Follow a story of care and independence through architectural puzzles, if the relationship gives the changing spaces a stronger reason to explore.**

**What you do.** Guide the journey through changing structures and manipulate the architecture as the relationship between the two travelers develops.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

**Main catch.** The PC description explicitly calls for clicking and dragging; check held movement, targets and recovery from mistakes.

**Why it might click.** Monument Valley 2 connects architectural illusion with a story of Ro and her child. The changing paths give its themes of care and independence a visual form. The developer describes it as a standalone adventure, so interest in this relationship does not require finishing the first game.

**The full catch.** The PC description explicitly calls for clicking and dragging to reshape the world. That is a concrete conditional barrier, even though the presentation is calm. Check how long manipulations must be held, target size and recovery from an unintended movement. The current storefront's shorter title still identifies the Panoramic edition in its detailed description.

**Try this first.** Try one early interaction involving the two travelers and the structure around them. Assess the drag action before assuming that a gentle story means physically effortless play.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

## P138 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

# Monument Valley 2: Panoramic Edition

**AIDEN AFTER HOURS / My Wife Didn't Need the Staircase I Had Built for Her**

I arranged two matching chairs beneath the impossible staircase backdrop. Same angle. Same view. A fair and loving gesture from a nigga who had neglected to ask.

Shawna moved hers.

'Baby, I made them match.' 'I know. Mine was facing the speaker.'

Mercedes adjusted the lights for Rosa's height instead of mine. Tank pulled a chair away from the draft. Little differences kept improving the room while I stood there mourning symmetry.

The backdrop's second figure seemed to be heading somewhere different from the first. I liked that once my wife pointed it out. A shared journey could include separate positions.

Porsche took a picture of us in our mismatched chairs. Shawna reached across the gap and held my hand.

'See? Still married.'

I asked whether the bedroom arrangements were similarly negotiable. She smiled. 'You can start by letting me choose the music.'

Tank turned the speaker down. 'Look at that. Nigga discovered cooperation without matching furniture.'

**Aiden's verdict.** Choose the second architectural story if care and growing independence appeal. The PC version explicitly involves dragging, so that physical condition belongs before the invitation.

**Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026**

Manually inspected correct Steam app 1927740. Detailed text identifies Panoramic Edition and explicitly describes clicking and dragging. Wrong or unresolved automatic cache excluded. Calm presentation is not a hold-free guarantee.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1927740/>

## P139 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

# The Room

Edition considered: PC original game

**Investigate an elaborate puzzle box, if noticing small details and uncovering a mechanism feels more inviting than navigating a large world.**

**What you do.** Inspect the box closely, examine its details and manipulate mechanisms to discover what the object is concealing.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

**Main catch.** Turning, zooming and dragging remain unresolved comfort checks; the primary premise does not certify a fully untimed route.

**Why it might click.** The Room offers close inspection of elaborate mechanical objects within an atmospheric mystery. Cryptic letters and unusual devices give each discovered mechanism a little narrative weight. Its concentrated setting may appeal more than walking through a large world, especially when the desired activity is examining something with a purpose.

**The full catch.** Close-up object puzzles can demand rotation, zooming, sliding and held pointer movement. The primary PC description calls the experience tactile but does not certify click-only controls. Check a representative latch or dial and the readability of details. The eerie tone may also matter even if the player is not controlling a combat character.

**Try this first.** Inspect the first object, identify one movable part and test the exact interaction. Learn how to leave a close-up before proceeding through several layers.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

## P139 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

# The Room

**AIDEN AFTER HOURS / The Box Had No Respect for How Much I Paid**

The casino delivered our centerpiece in a carved wooden box. I expected champagne. The box had a dial, a hidden latch, and the attitude of a motherfucker who knew I had an audience.

I tried opening it with confidence. Nothing. Tank offered his hands. Shawna caught his wrist. 'It's rented.'

Mercedes noticed a small mark near the hinge. Rosa turned the box toward the light. Suddenly the object became worth examining instead of merely defeating.

I followed one detail to another. A little movement produced a satisfying click. The lid still stayed shut.

'Foreplay,' I announced.

My wife looked at the box. 'At least somebody here knows how to build anticipation.'

Every nigga at the table made the same noise. I kept my attention on the latch because it was the only relationship in the room I could currently improve.

Inside was a smaller compartment.

Tank sat down. 'That box getting its money's worth out of you.'

**Aiden's verdict.** Try the mechanical mystery if close inspection feels inviting. Test turning, zooming and dragging directly; the box's excellent dramatic timing is not proof of comfortable controls.

**Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026**

Exact-title developer/publisher Steam description inspected for premise and edition. Fit and first trial are editorial suggestions. Controls, timing and comfort remain bounded by the explicit checks in the card; no complete playthrough performed.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/288160/>

## P140 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

# The Room Two

Edition considered: PC release

**Continue The Room's mechanical mystery in broader spaces, if examining objects remains enjoyable and a larger investigation sounds welcome.**

**What you do.** Investigate objects and mechanisms, follow the scientist's letters and connect discoveries across the spaces presented by the game.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

**Main catch.** Expanded environments add location and object memory, while turning, zooming and dragging still need a PC-specific check.

**Why it might click.** The Room Two continues the series' mechanical mystery while expanding the spaces and objects to investigate. Following an enigmatic scientist's letters gives the tactile puzzle work a thread to pursue. It may suit someone who liked the first game's close observation and wants a broader version of that activity.

**The full catch.** An expanded environment can add object and location memory to the familiar manipulation demands. Check turning, zooming, dragging and moving between viewpoints in the PC release rather than carrying over assumptions from a mobile version. The primary source establishes a rebuilt PC edition, not universal comfort or a completely untimed completion path.

**Try this first.** Investigate one object in the opening area and complete a single interaction chain. Notice whether finding the next relevant object feels inviting or starts to become visual clutter.

## AIDEN AFTER HOURS / The Second Box Had Brought Friends

I solved the first ornamental latch and announced that the evening's intellectual work was complete. The host rolled out another table.

Three boxes. Tank looked at me. 'Nigga, your success has reproduced.'

Shawna picked one object to examine. Mercedes stayed with a letter beside it. Rosa moved the lamp rather than letting us crowd around the shadow.

I wanted to touch everything because expansion felt like a challenge to my status. Porsche handed me one small piece and pointed to the place it belonged. A useful job. Humiliatingly effective.

The objects began suggesting relationships. Not every surface needed my attention at once. I could stay with a thread until it actually led somewhere.

Then the host offered a premium package with still more boxes.

'Nigga, no,' I said.

My wife leaned against me. 'Listen to you, setting a boundary.'

Tank applauded. 'Somebody record this. He just turned down extra.'

**Aiden's verdict.** Choose the expanded room if following one mechanical thread still feels enjoyable. More locations add remembering and manipulation demands, so let curiosity set the size of the visit.

## Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Exact-title developer/publisher Steam description inspected for premise and edition. Fit and first trial are editorial suggestions. Controls, timing and comfort remain bounded by the explicit checks in the card; no complete playthrough performed.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/425580/>

## The Velvet Rope Could Not Tell Who Was Grown

I found a coloring toy beside a severe-looking logic puzzle and suggested putting the childish things at the far end of the lounge. Mercedes turned slowly. This is a useful warning sign if a nigga values the next five minutes of his life.

'Childish-looking,' she said. 'And some people might want it. Other people might want a serious story. You could ask instead of standing there ranking their childhoods.' Tank moved the velvet rope away from both tables. Dre picked a ridiculous blue dinosaur. Rosa chose a mechanical mystery. Nobody's adulthood changed at the door.

Then the logic puzzle defeated my first three ideas. Its little creature looked friendly as hell while declining to cooperate. Shawna pointed out that cute and easy had never signed a joint contract. I tried to blame the lighting. Porsche moved the lamp. Now I could see myself being wrong with excellent clarity.

The room improved when we described the actual activity. Drawing a route. Dragging a part. Remembering a clue. Waiting for an opening. Comparing several ideas. Some of these were welcome tonight; some were not. The costume around them did not get the final vote.

Dre showed me his dinosaur. 'My nigga got taste.' It was blue, purple and completely free of narrative ambition. He enjoyed it and handed the controller onward. Mercedes returned to her mystery. I sat with my wife and tried the little logic problem again. She asked whether I wanted a hint. 'Yes,' I said. Tank nearly dropped his glass. Nigga acted like I had confessed to another marriage.

## P141 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

# The Room Three

Edition considered: PC release

**Investigate a mysterious island and its intricate mechanisms, if a larger setting makes the invitation to examine objects more compelling.**

**What you do.** Explore the presented spaces, inspect mechanisms and follow clues through the trials associated with the elusive Craftsman.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

**Main catch.** More navigation and location memory join close manipulation; dragging, holds and full-game timing remain to be checked.

**Why it might click.** The Room Three expands mechanical puzzle investigation into a mysterious island and the trials of an elusive Craftsman. Its rebuilt PC presentation offers richly detailed objects and spaces. This is a candidate for someone who enjoys handling intricate mysteries and wants a broader setting around the mechanisms.

**The full catch.** Broader spaces can increase navigation and remembered-location demands. Close manipulation still needs an exact-device check for turning, dragging and zooming; a mouse interface does not establish that everything is click-only. The inspected description does not certify every later interaction as untimed. Eerie isolation is part of the appeal, so choose it for that mood rather than assuming the title means a quiet decorating game.

**Try this first.** Inspect the first available mechanism and follow one clue to its consequence. Check manipulation comfort before treating the island's larger mysteries as a commitment.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

## P141 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

# The Room Three

**AIDEN AFTER HOURS / The Private Island Was a Locked Room with Better Marketing**

The invitation promised an island experience. I followed the host into a dark lounge with a painted ocean and a cabinet that refused to open.

Tank read the brochure. 'Nigga, they put us on shore leave from the buffet.'

I asked for the Craftsman. A man in a velvet waistcoat bowed. Mercedes asked whether the cabinet had a real maker or just a branding department.

He showed us one beautifully made joint. Shawna touched the edge and found a seam I'd missed. The object had more thought in it than the invitation.

Rosa sat near the lamp. She wanted to follow the mystery. Tank wanted to know whether the island served food after ten. Different questions. Both deserved an answer.

I turned a little mechanism and heard something move farther inside.

'There,' my wife said. 'Better than kicking it.'

I had not mentioned kicking it. Marriage gives a woman dangerous access to a nigga's unpublished methods.

**Aiden's verdict.** Choose the broader mechanical mystery if the setting deepens your curiosity. More space and object relationships add demands; the beautiful cabinet still needs a direct input check.

**Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026**

Exact-title developer/publisher Steam description inspected for premise and edition. Fit and first trial are editorial suggestions. Controls, timing and comfort remain bounded by the explicit checks in the card; no complete playthrough performed.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/456750/>

## P142 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

# The Room 4: Old Sins

Edition considered: PC release

**Explore a dollhouse concealing a darker domestic mystery, if detailed rooms and their connections make you want to understand what happened.**

**What you do.** Investigate the dollhouse's rooms, manipulate tactile contraptions and follow the disappearance story through objects and their relationships.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

**Main catch.** Room switching and object uses add memory work; turning, dragging and complete-path timing remain unverified.

**Why it might click.** Old Sins frames its mechanical puzzles around an unusual dollhouse and a disappearance at Waldegrave Manor. An engineer, his wife and a sought-after artifact give the investigation a darker domestic story. The PC edition rebuilds the visual presentation around detailed rooms and their interconnections.

**The full catch.** The dollhouse is a mysterious adult setting, not evidence of simple mechanics. Moving among rooms and tracking object uses can add memory demands; rotating and manipulating mechanisms may involve sustained pointer actions. Check the PC controls directly. The reviewed source establishes the premise and tactile puzzles, but leaves full-game timing and hold requirements unresolved.

**Try this first.** Explore one dollhouse area and identify what changed after a single mechanism. Continue if the relationship between the small room and the larger mystery feels satisfying.

## AIDEN AFTER HOURS / The Dollhouse Had a Better Sex Life Than the Hotel

The centerpiece turned out to be a miniature mansion with lights in every room. I leaned close and announced that the tiny master suite seemed underused.

Shawna folded her arms. 'Nigga, you criticizing their marriage before ours has had dessert?'

Mercedes opened a little door. Behind it sat an object that changed the story she'd imagined about the house. Rosa noticed something in another room. Their attention grew serious while I was still inspecting miniature curtains.

A small domestic space could hold a large secret. I liked that. The little furniture stopped looking like decoration and started looking like evidence.

Tank peered through a tiny window. 'They got a kitchen?'

Porsche turned the house toward him. He nodded with deep professional approval.

I suggested putting our own suite into miniature. My wife touched my tie. 'Let's see what you do with the full-size one first.'

Every nigga pretended not to hear. Every nigga heard.

**Aiden's verdict.** Take the dollhouse mystery if rooms full of human secrets appeal. Small scale does not guarantee simple controls, and its darker domestic story deserves a taste check.

## Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Exact-title developer/publisher Steam description inspected for premise and edition. Fit and first trial are editorial suggestions. Controls, timing and comfort remain bounded by the explicit checks in the card; no complete playthrough performed.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1361320/>

## P143 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

# The House of Da Vinci

Edition considered: PC release

**Investigate Leonardo's disappearance through Renaissance machinery, if a fictional historical mystery gives mechanical puzzles a more compelling reason to solve them.**

**What you do.** Inspect the workshop's objects, solve mechanical puzzles and use unusual devices to examine the environment in different ways.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

**Main catch.** Small details, object memory, viewpoint changes and tactile manipulation need checking; a point-and-click label does not eliminate holds.

**Why it might click.** As Leonardo's apprentice, investigate his disappearance through mechanical puzzles and hidden objects in a Renaissance setting. Special devices add unusual ways to inspect the environment. The appeal is fictional intrigue joined to elaborate machinery, with an atmosphere inspired by historical inventions rather than a plain sequence of abstract boards.

**The full catch.** Inspecting objects can involve viewpoint changes and tactile manipulation; do not assume that a point-and-click label eliminates dragging or holds. Puzzles may require noticing small details and remembering where a device belongs. The source describes a fictional adventure, not a history lesson or a verified fully untimed control path. Test the intended PC input arrangement.

**Try this first.** Examine one early device and identify its moving parts before trying to solve everything nearby. Check whether manipulating it feels pleasant enough to support a longer mystery.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

## P143 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

# The House of Da Vinci

**AIDEN AFTER HOURS / Leonardo Would Have Asked Me to Leave the Workshop**

The casino's Renaissance host called me apprentice. I corrected him. 'Nigga, I arrive at master level.'  
He handed me a mechanism. It remained closed.

Tank leaned over the table. 'Master of holding that shit.'

Shawna noticed a moving part. Mercedes asked where its motion led. Rosa watched the host's demonstration instead of my face, which robbed the evening of some excellent expressions.

I wanted the pleasure of a machine revealing its logic. I did not particularly want the preliminary period in which the machine ignored my reputation. Apparently the two came together.

The host said Leonardo's workshop required patience. I said he should have met my accountant.

My wife placed my hand beside the correct part. 'There. Start by looking.'

I did. Something connected. The mechanism opened. Tank clapped. 'Nigga invented listening.'

I considered putting that on a plaque, but Shawna had already found the next interesting thing and I wanted to see it too.

**Aiden's verdict.** Try the Renaissance mystery if its machinery and missing-master story appeal. Manipulation and small details remain practical checks; a historical atmosphere does not certify simple actions.

**Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026**

Exact-title developer/publisher Steam description inspected for premise and edition. Fit and first trial are editorial suggestions. Controls, timing and comfort remain bounded by the explicit checks in the card; no complete playthrough performed.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/522470/>

## P144 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

# The House of Da Vinci 2

Edition considered: PC release

**Follow a narrated Renaissance mystery where actions connect past and present, if discovering consequences across time sounds interesting to you.**

**What you do.** Investigate mechanisms, listen to the story and use the time-related device to understand connections between earlier and present conditions.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

**Main catch.** Redesigned controls are not proof of low demand, and multiple time relationships can add substantial remembering work.

**Why it might click.** The second House of Da Vinci combines Renaissance mystery, mechanical puzzles and a device that connects past actions with present conditions. The developer describes a fully narrated story and redesigned controls. Those are useful distinctions to check when choosing this installment, particularly if hearing the narrative is part of its appeal.

**The full catch.** Redesigned controls are not proof of low physical demand. Test the actual manipulation, viewpoint changes and dragging on the PC version. Time travel can increase the number of relationships to remember, and narration does not guarantee that every clue is spoken. The reviewed source does not settle all later timed interactions or the option to avoid sustained input.

**Try this first.** Try one narrated scene and one mechanical interaction. Notice separately whether the voices help the story and whether the device controls feel comfortable.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

## P144 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

# The House of Da Vinci 2

**AIDEN AFTER HOURS / Time Travel Was Going to Fix My Drink Bill**

The second Renaissance room offered a device that connected past and present. I immediately asked whether it could reach the moment before I ordered the premium champagne.

Tank shook his head. 'Nigga trying to erase the only decision I enjoyed.'

Shawna turned one part and watched another change. Mercedes followed the narrated explanation. Cause and effect made the room feel larger than the table in front of us.

I imagined repairing my earlier mistakes. Wrong corridor. Extra fountain. The speech with a second ending. My wife asked why my first thought about time travel wasn't meeting her sooner.

I stopped. 'Baby, that was obviously implied.'

Rosa laughed without looking away from the device. Tank said history should keep the receipts.

I watched the little change happen again and found it satisfying enough without rewriting my life. Then Shawna kissed me.

'You can improve the next ten minutes,' she said.

Finally. A manageable timeline with excellent incentives.

**Aiden's verdict.** Choose the time-linked mystery if following consequences sounds rewarding. Narration may help the story, but revised controls still need checking and multiple periods add relationships to remember.

**Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026**

Exact-title developer/publisher Steam description inspected for premise and edition. Fit and first trial are editorial suggestions. Controls, timing and comfort remain bounded by the explicit checks in the card; no complete playthrough performed.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1259840/>

P145 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

# The House of Da Vinci 3

Edition considered: PC release

**Continue Giacomo's Renaissance adventure through conspiracies and machinery, if the series' characters and atmosphere already make its conclusion appealing to you.**

**What you do.** Follow the concluding story, inspect mechanical puzzles and investigate the time-related mysteries surrounding Giacomo and Leonardo's journey together.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

**Main catch.** Finale context, manipulation and viewpoint controls make this conditional; full-route timing is not verified by the reviewed source.

**Why it might click.** The third game concludes Giacomo's adventure with Leonardo, combining mechanical puzzles, time-related mysteries and conspiracies across Italian settings. The developer advertises voiced historical figures within the fictional story. It is most appealing as a continuation for someone already enjoying the series' machinery and atmosphere.

**The full catch.** A finale can carry more narrative context than a first encounter needs. Its polished presentation and claims of intuitive interaction do not verify click-only play or absence of required holds. Check the PC manipulation and camera behavior, and establish whether prior story knowledge matters to the intended experience. Full-route timing remains unverified in this source pass.

**Try this first.** Watch or inspect the opening premise without racing onward. If the characters and controls are already familiar, try one mechanism; otherwise consider starting with the first installment.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

## P145 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

# The House of Da Vinci 3

**AIDEN AFTER HOURS / The Finale Arrived Before I Understood the First Affair**

The host announced the final chapter of the Renaissance entertainment. I applauded as if I had followed every conspiracy. Mercedes asked me who the missing man was.

'Nigga with enemies.' 'Specific.'

Shawna knew. Rosa remembered the earlier conversation. Tank remembered who had brought the appetizers and was willing to build his entire theory from that.

The finale offered a bigger reason for the machinery, but it also asked us to bring something from what came before. I could enjoy the beautiful room without pretending context was an optional accessory.

Porsche offered a quick recap. I accepted before my pride ordered another explanation from the wrong person.

Then I heard a character's name and genuinely knew why it mattered.

'Look at you,' my wife said. 'I been following.'

Tank raised a finger. 'Nigga, we watched you arrive.'

I let him have it. Knowing the story felt better than winning the argument about when I started listening.

**Aiden's verdict.** Continue the trilogy when its people and mechanisms already matter to you. A finale's context can enrich it, while also making it a less convenient first visit.

**Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026**

Exact-title developer/publisher Steam description inspected for premise and edition. Fit and first trial are editorial suggestions. Controls, timing and comfort remain bounded by the explicit checks in the card; no complete playthrough performed.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1603640/>

## P146 / A PLACE TO START

# Carto

Edition considered: PC release

**Help Carto find her grandmother by rearranging the map itself, if changing geography sounds like a playful way to solve a journey.**

**What you do.** Rearrange map pieces to create paths, then move through the changed world and meet people along the route.

Mixed controls | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

**Main catch.** Map manipulation and character movement are separate activities; check dragging, rotation and held movement before settling in.

**Why it might click.** Carto combines a journey to reunite with Granny with puzzles that rearrange the map itself. Changing the arrangement creates new paths and possibilities in the world. Friendly encounters and varied communities give the spatial puzzle a human thread, offering more story context than an isolated logic board.

**The full catch.** There are two activities to learn: moving the character and manipulating map pieces. Check rotation, placement, any dragging and the amount of direction holding needed for walking. The peaceful presentation is encouraging, but it does not establish every interaction as untimed or effortless. Later map relationships may demand more spatial reasoning than the first examples suggest.

**Try this first.** Complete one map change, then walk the resulting route and notice what it changed. Judge whether switching between map thinking and character movement feels natural.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

## P146 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

# Carto

**AIDEN AFTER HOURS / I Moved the Bedroom on the Map and Expected the Hotel to Cooperate**

Shawna pointed out that our suite was a long walk from the lounge. I moved its room card beside the elevator on the floor plan.

'Fixed it, baby.' She looked at me. 'Nigga, the room still upstairs.'

Mercedes rearranged the event cards beside mine. One move made the terrace connect neatly to the dining area. Another gave Rosa a quieter route to the stage. The paper version of the party improved fast.

I loved the fantasy of geography listening to a hand. Put two places together and discover a new way through them.

Tank moved the buffet card onto his chair. 'I'm ready for the technology.'

Porsche took the practical changes to the manager. A few were possible. My relocated suite was not.

Shawna slipped the original room key into my palm. 'Old-fashioned travel tonight.'

I offered her my arm. The walk suddenly looked manageable.

Tank kept his card. Nigga believed in a better future.

**Aiden's verdict.** Choose the map-changing journey if rearranging space sounds delightful. You still alternate between map work and character movement, so try that switch before assuming the whole route feels easy.

**Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026**

Exact-title developer/publisher Steam description inspected for premise and edition. Fit and first trial are editorial suggestions. Controls, timing and comfort remain bounded by the explicit checks in the card; no complete playthrough performed.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1172450/>

## P147 / A MORE DEMANDING DETOUR

# Chants of Sennaar

Edition considered: PC release

**Decode languages and discover a divided tower's peoples, if understanding symbols is appealing enough to consider the adventure's separate stealth demands.**

**What you do.** Observe conversations and scenes, record meanings in the notebook and revise symbol interpretations while traveling through the tower.

Mouse / pointer | Some real-time demands | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

**Main catch.** Developer-confirmed guard timing conflicts with a strict no-rush route, despite useful mouse-only and camera-comfort declarations.

**Why it might click.** Chants of Sennaar builds a tower journey around interpreting several interconnected languages. Observation, conversations and a notebook of symbols support the process of finding meaning. Its distinctive appeal is the moment when a scene becomes understandable, with communication across separated peoples supplying a larger purpose.

**The full catch.** The developer explicitly confirms stealth sections that require choosing a path and timing movement around guard patterns. This conflicts with a strict no-rush route. The Steam listing's mouse-only and camera-comfort declarations do not remove that demand, and the developer says the gamepad cover/free toggle does not apply to mouse-and-keyboard play. Language deduction also adds substantial memory work.

**Try this first.** Explore the early language puzzle only if that bounded visit is wanted. Preview the stealth requirements before committing; do not promise that enjoying the opening makes the full game suitable.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

## P147 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

# Chants of Sennaar

**AIDEN AFTER HOURS / The Sign Could Mean Welcome or Get Your Ass Out**

I greeted the foreign-language sign outside the themed lounge as if confidence could translate it. Mercedes asked what it said.

'Important guests this way.' Porsche checked the staff placard. 'Service entrance, nigga.'

Inside, symbols repeated across menus and decorations. Rosa noticed one beside a drink. Shawna found it again near a doorway. Meaning started to gather from use instead of my optimism.

I enjoyed that little discovery. Then the entertainment host announced a sneaking challenge across the next room. Tank looked at the moving staff silhouettes and sat down.

'Nigga, I came to understand the sign, not time my ass between security.'

Fair. One appealing activity did not oblige us to accept another. Mercedes kept studying the symbols at our table. Rosa ordered a drink she now recognized.

I finally made a correct translation.

Shawna smiled. 'What does it say?' 'Stay here with my wife.'

'That's not on the sign.' 'Working theory, baby.'

**Aiden's verdict.** Keep the language mystery as a conditional detour for its verified stealth timing. Enjoying a thoughtful opening does not make the later moving-guard requirement disappear.

**Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026**

Steam premise and declared input categories; developer Rundisc replies of December 4, 2023 and March 23, 2024 explicitly confirm stealth timing and distinguish gamepad from mouse/keyboard. No whole-game no-rush claim.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/1931770/>

Source 2: <https://steamcommunity.com/app/1931770/discussions/0/4040354734349221032/>

P148 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

# Heaven's Vault

Edition considered: PC release

**Explore archaeology through an evolving character story, if translations that remain uncertain make discovery more interesting than simply finding a correct answer.**

**What you do.** Talk with characters, examine inscriptions and explore the world while developing and revising theories about its ancient language.

Mixed controls | Some real-time demands | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

**Main catch.** Exploration includes sailing and navigation; camera or held travel input and heavy interpretation memory need checking.

**Why it might click.** Heaven's Vault follows archaeologist Aliya and her robot companion Six through a network of places and histories. Translating an ancient language is woven into an adaptive story, where discoveries and interpretations affect the journey. It offers grown-up curiosity, character exchanges and the possibility of forming a theory that later evidence complicates.

**The full catch.** This is more than a static translation screen: exploration includes navigation and sailing, and the source describes fast-flowing space rivers. Check camera movement, sustained travel input and the handling of those sequences. Tracking inscriptions, earlier interpretations and story choices can be demanding. Do not read its reflective subject matter as proof that every physical action waits comfortably.

**Try this first.** Try one conversation and one inscription before evaluating a travel sequence separately. Keep a translation provisional and notice whether uncertainty feels intriguing or merely burdensome.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

## P148 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

# Heaven's Vault

**AIDEN AFTER HOURS / The Ancient Inscription Was Probably Somebody's Bar Tab**

The antiquities display included a stone covered in symbols. I announced it recorded the arrival of a legendary king. Tank asked whether the king had settled his room charges.

Mercedes studied a repeated mark. Shawna found a related shape on another object. Their guesses changed as more details appeared.

I liked the uncertainty until my own theory lost support. Then I considered declaring the stone damaged.

'Nigga, evidence ain't broken because you wrong,' Rosa said.

An adult collector beside us launched into a speech about his yacht and the cocaine party he'd hosted on it. Mercedes turned the display lamp away from his reflection.

The old writing was more interesting. Somebody had meant something. We could approach it without owning it immediately.

I crossed out KING and wrote MAYBE.

Shawna rested her chin on my shoulder. 'Sexy word on you.'

Tank looked at my page. 'Nigga discovered doubt and got flirted with. Research paying off.'

**Aiden's verdict.** Choose the archaeological story if uncertain translations and evolving relationships appeal. Exploration and sailing add movement demands, while keeping interpretations provisional can become substantial mental work.

**Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026**

Exact-title developer/publisher Steam description inspected for premise and edition. Fit and first trial are editorial suggestions. Controls, timing and comfort remain bounded by the explicit checks in the card; no complete playthrough performed.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/774201/>

P149 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

# Return of the Obra Dinn

Edition considered: PC release

**Reconstruct the mystery of a merchant ship that returned without its crew, if a large network of human clues sounds compelling.**

**What you do.** Explore the ship, inspect details and use logical deduction to work out the events connected to its missing crew.

Movement + camera | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

**Main catch.** First-person controls, many identities and disturbing death-related material make this a substantial conditional mystery.

**Why it might click.** Return of the Obra Dinn casts the player as an insurance investigator examining a merchant ship that has returned without its crew. The developer emphasizes first-person exploration and logical deduction. Its appeal is reconstructing a complicated human mystery through observation, making it a strong story-and-evidence candidate for the right input setup.

**The full catch.** First-person navigation brings camera coordination and movement holds into the assessment. Connecting many identities and events can also impose a large memory burden, while the ship's fate involves death and disturbing material. The inspected primary description is brief; it does not establish every timing or interaction requirement. Choose it for substantial deduction, not as a low-effort introduction to mysteries.

**Try this first.** Inspect the opening environment and the investigation interface. Check visual comfort and navigation before deciding whether maintaining a larger network of people and clues sounds enjoyable.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

## P149 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

# Return of the Obra Dinn

**AIDEN AFTER HOURS / The Insurance Man Wanted to Know What Happened to the Buffet Ship**

I rented a decorative ship for the seafood table. By midnight its sails leaned, the shrimp were gone, and one tiny sailor had vanished inside Tank's napkin.

The insurer asked what had happened. Every nigga looked at Tank.

'Circumstantial,' he said.

Shawna examined the little deck. Mercedes reconstructed who had moved the tray. Rosa remembered the waiter carrying the broken mast. Suddenly a ridiculous object held a sequence of human decisions.

I found the logic absorbing. A detail made another detail matter. A missing piece changed the account. My original answer, GREAT PARTY, was not adequate documentation.

Tank produced the sailor from his pocket. 'He survived.' The insurer wrote something.

'Nigga, don't put that on my premium,' I said.

Shawna handed over the broken sail and told the truth. It was less flattering than my version and considerably more useful.

Tank asked whether the survivors were entitled to dessert. The insurer finally laughed.

**Aiden's verdict.** Choose the ship's deduction if reconstructing human events sounds compelling. Its large identity puzzle, death-related content and first-person navigation keep this a substantial, conditional undertaking.

**Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026**

Exact-title developer/publisher Steam description inspected for premise and edition. Fit and first trial are editorial suggestions. Controls, timing and comfort remain bounded by the explicit checks in the card; no complete playthrough performed.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/653530/>

## P150 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

# Opus Magnum

Edition considered: PC release

**Build working alchemical machines within a story of ambition, if arranging a mechanism and watching it succeed sounds like the central pleasure.**

**What you do.** Place equipment, sequence its instructions and revise the arrangement until the machine performs the required transformation successfully on its own.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

**Main catch.** The editor, component placement and sequencing are complex, and optimization comparisons can add unnecessary self-imposed pressure.

**Why it might click.** Opus Magnum is an open-ended machine-building puzzle about arranging and programming alchemical equipment. Several solutions can work, with optional interest in making them cheaper, smaller or faster. A story of ambition and intrigue surrounds the workshop, while watching a successful mechanism repeat its work provides a distinctive reward.

**The full catch.** The editor, component placement and instruction sequencing create substantial interface and reasoning demands. Optimization comparisons can introduce self-imposed pressure even when a solution already works. Machine execution speed is not the same thing as required human reaction speed, but exact editing holds and all control requirements still need checking. The narrative is woven around construction rather than replacing it.

**Try this first.** Follow one introductory construction and make a single operation work. Ignore efficiency comparisons while deciding whether arranging and revising a machine is enjoyable in itself.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

## P150 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

# Opus Magnum

**AIDEN AFTER HOURS / The Machine Could Pour Drinks but Couldn't Take a Compliment**

I commissioned a mechanical cocktail display. An arm moved a glass, another turned a bottle, and the whole thing made me want to announce the future before it had served anybody.

Tank waited with an empty cup. 'Nigga, future thirsty.'

Shawna changed one part of the sequence. The arms stopped colliding. Mercedes watched the repeated movement settle into something elegant.

I immediately asked whether it could go faster. Rosa asked whether the drink tasted good. Better question. Irritating timing.

The first successful cycle was enough to enjoy. Parts doing what they were supposed to do, without a man shouting instructions over them.

Then I requested an extra arm that would point toward me after each pour.

Shawna unplugged my proposal verbally. 'No.'

Tank accepted the drink. 'Machine working. Nigga still under development.'

I took the next cup and watched the mechanism run. The steady little rhythm was more convincing than another speech about my role in creating it.

**Aiden's verdict.** Try the alchemical construction if arranging a working mechanism sounds satisfying. Its editor and sequencing are demanding; comparisons about speed and size need not become the evening's purpose.

**Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026**

Exact-title developer/publisher Steam description inspected for premise and edition. Fit and first trial are editorial suggestions. Controls, timing and comfort remain bounded by the explicit checks in the card; no complete playthrough performed.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/558990/>

## Darnell Tried to Put Cocaine in the Escape-Room Budget

Darnell announced that the puzzle lounge needed more energy. He patted the pocket containing his little cocaine bag. Porsche looked at the untouched games, the available food and the six separate adults who had already moved away from his boat speech. 'Nigga, the room got energy. Your conversation got a leak.'

He said he could make the night unforgettable. Rosa said her song had already done that for the people listening. Mercedes asked whether anybody wanted to continue the picture puzzle. Three hands went up. Darnell's did not. He wanted spectators, not partners, which was a distinction I recognized with uncomfortable speed.

I almost defended him on behalf of every man who had ever mistaken a large announcement for an experience. Shawna caught the thought before it left my mouth. 'You can enjoy being here too, baby. You don't have to keep producing us.' She pulled a chair beside her. I sat.

Dre moved his casserole away from Darnell's pocket and told him to choose a game or help carry dishes. No sermon. Just an actual job available in the room. Darnell picked up a tray. Tank showed him where it went. For the first time all evening he completed a route without explaining how it compared to his yacht.

When he returned, Mercedes asked whether he wanted to try one panel of the picture puzzle. He said yes. They looked at it together. A minute passed without an audience. I leaned toward Shawna and whispered that personal growth appeared possible even at our event. She kissed me. 'Careful, nigga. Don't turn his minute into your speech.'

## P151 / A PLACE TO START

# Sokobond

Edition considered: PC release

**Make molecular connections into compact logic puzzles, if discovering spatial relationships appeals without needing prior knowledge of chemistry to begin.**

**What you do.** Move through introductory molecular arrangements, observe the result of each action and revise the spatial idea when needed.

Direction + buttons | Usually waits for choices | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

**Main catch.** Untimed-input support is declared, but key behavior, undo comfort and reasoning demands still need a practical check.

**Why it might click.** Sokobond turns molecular connections into compact logic puzzles with a minimalist presentation. The developer explicitly says chemistry knowledge is not required. Its current Steam declarations include keyboard-only play and play without timed input, making this a useful candidate when deliberate problem-solving is welcome but reaction pressure is not.

**The full catch.** A small control vocabulary can still support difficult spatial reasoning. Confirm comfortable key presses, any repeat behavior and how undo works on the actual device. The developer's no-timed-input declaration is useful evidence, not a hands-on comfort guarantee. This is mainly abstract puzzle pleasure; it will not supply the character-rich narrative that motivates some other choices in the catalog.

**Try this first.** Try one introductory molecular puzzle and learn the result of a single movement. Continue only if revising a spatial idea feels satisfying, without requiring prior chemistry expertise.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

## P151 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

# Sokobond

**AIDEN AFTER HOURS / The Atoms Refused to Respect My Social Status**

I arranged cocktail olives into what I called a powerful molecular formation. Shawna asked which molecule. 'Rich nigga.'

Mercedes moved one olive. 'Now it's humble nigga.' Tank ate another. The chemistry became urgent.

The real attraction was simpler than my performance: a few connected pieces could obey rules worth discovering. Nobody had to arrive wearing a laboratory coat and pretending to remember school.

Rosa tried one arrangement, then another. Porsche watched how the connection changed the possible next move. Their attention made the little problem feel more interesting than my invented scientific reputation.

I asked if our formation could produce a particularly romantic reaction upstairs. My wife took the cocktail pick out of my hand.

'Start with not putting olives on the bed.'

Tank finished the remaining sample. 'Experiment complete.'

I protested the loss of data. He patted his stomach. 'Still preserved, nigga. Different research facility.'

Mercedes ordered a fresh bowl and assigned him a chair farther from the laboratory.

**Aiden's verdict.** Try the molecule puzzles if discovering spatial rules sounds satisfying. No chemistry background is required, and declared untimed input helps; exact movement comfort still needs checking.

**Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026**

Exact Steam source supports chemistry-themed puzzles without required chemistry knowledge. Current developer declarations include Keyboard Only Option and Playable without Timed Input. Those declarations are not a hands-on test of sustained keys or individual comfort. Remote Play Together is not treated as native co-op.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/290260/>

## P152 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

# Hexcells

Edition considered: PC original game

**Try an ambient cell-based logic puzzle, if studying a compact board and finding a justified next move sounds enjoyable to you.**

**What you do.** Read the board's instructions, inspect its cells and make selections based on the relationships you can establish from the clues.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

**Main catch.** The primary description is brief; exact input, readability, holding and full timing requirements remain unresolved.

**Why it might click.** Hexcells is presented by its developer as an ambient logic puzzle. Its compact cell-based format offers a different kind of interest from walking through a world: inspect the board, understand its rules and look for a reasoned next step. It is a candidate for someone who likes deliberate abstract deduction.

**The full catch.** The inspected primary description is unusually brief, so it does not substantiate a full no-timer or hold-free claim. Check the game's instructions, cell readability and the distinction between its input actions before relying on it. A sparse screen does not guarantee an easy deduction. This original Hexcells entry should not inherit features or extra modes from the separate Plus and Infinite games.

**Try this first.** Read the opening board instructions and make one move whose reason is clear. Check whether selecting and distinguishing cells feels comfortable before increasing the puzzle size.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

## P152 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

# Hexcells

**AIDEN AFTER HOURS / Six Sides and Not One of Them Agreed with Me**

The casino put hexagonal tiles beneath the drinks. I moved them into a pattern and told Tank the arrangement had six different ways to prove I was right.

He looked down. 'Nigga, I only need one where your glass stops wobbling.'

Shawna rotated a tile. Mercedes noticed a relationship between two marks. A quiet problem formed in the middle of the noisy room.

Rosa lowered the music near us without turning the moment into a ceremony. We could look. Make one careful choice. See whether the next choice became clearer.

I tried pointing dramatically. It added nothing. Porsche slid my finger aside so everybody could read the mark underneath.

Then the arrangement made sense. Small satisfaction. No fireworks. I liked it.

Tank put his drink down. Steady.

'Good work, my nigga. Your theory finally supporting something.'

I raised my glass and nearly forgot why it had been steady. Shawna caught the loose tile before I could reinvent the entire problem.

**Aiden's verdict.** Choose the compact logic format if a carefully justified move sounds pleasurable. Its brief primary description leaves full timing and control details unresolved, so begin with a small board.

**Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026**

The exact-game Steam page describes an ambient logic puzzle; its short primary text does not establish full controls or timing. The separate sequels' features were not imported. Detailed input verification remains outstanding.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/265890/>

## P153 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

# Tametsi

Edition considered: PC release

**Work through demanding tile logic with drawing tools and saved progress, if making a supported deduction is itself a satisfying reward.**

**What you do.** Inspect tile relationships, reason about hidden mines and use the drawing tools to keep notes while developing a solution.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

**Main catch.** The developer explicitly calls it difficult; large clue relationships, tile visibility and exact controls still need checking.

**Why it might click.** Tametsi offers demanding logic puzzles about finding hidden mines among tiles. The developer says solutions do not require guessing, provides on-screen drawing tools for notes, and saves progress even within a level. For someone who enjoys careful deduction, those features can support a substantial problem without requiring an immediate answer.

**The full catch.** The developer also explicitly describes the game as difficult. Large patterns, written notes and relationships between clues can become mentally busy even when the physical action is modest. Verify the click controls, tile visibility and stopping behavior on the device. The inspected text supports automatic progress saving, but it does not explicitly certify every input as hold-free or every activity as untimed.

**Try this first.** Try an early board and write down one deduction with the available note tools. Decide whether the reasoning itself is enjoyable before treating more difficult boards as an objective.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

## P153 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

# Tametsi

**AIDEN AFTER HOURS / The Tile Needed Evidence and Tank Was Offering Vibes**

Tank pointed at one square on the party's puzzle mat. 'That one.' Shawna asked why. He considered the question.

'Energy.' Mercedes put his hand back beside his plate. 'Nigga, eat. We need evidence.'

I almost defended intuition until Rosa asked me to explain my own choice. The explanation began confidently and ended in a vague circle over the table.

We tried writing the reasons down. One clue limited another. A mark ruled out a possibility. The problem did not get smaller, but it got less mysterious in the unhelpful way.

Porsche left the unfinished arrangement alone when the music changed. We could come back to it. Nobody needed to solve everything before dancing.

I asked Shawna whether she found logical certainty attractive. 'Sometimes. Right now I'm attracted to that song.'

We went.

Tank stayed with the mat until Mercedes called him. Then he pointed once more. 'Still that one.'

Nigga had a theory. It remained unsupported.

**Aiden's verdict.** Choose the difficult tile logic if proof itself is enjoyable. Saving progress supports returning later, while large clue relationships and exact input still deserve an honest trial.

**Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026**

Exact-title developer/publisher Steam description inspected for premise and edition. Fit and first trial are editorial suggestions. Controls, timing and comfort remain bounded by the explicit checks in the card; no complete playthrough performed.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/709920/>

## P154 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

# Mario Paint

Edition considered: 1992 SNES original; SNES Mouse input

**Make a playful picture in the original SNES creative toy, using stamps and fills as a narrow first activity to enjoy.**

**What you do.** Choose a stamp and a fill color, place a few elements and experiment with a small picture using the mouse.

Mouse / pointer | Some real-time demands | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

**Main catch.** Original hardware needs the SNES Mouse; other tools involve dragging, many icons add clutter, and Gnat Attack requires reactions.

**Why it might click.** The original SNES Mario Paint is a creative toy for pictures, music and animation, built around the SNES Mouse. Stamping and filling areas offer a narrower first activity than exploring the entire toolbox. Its appeal is making something playful, with nostalgia as an optional bonus rather than a requirement.

**The full catch.** The original hardware needs the mouse peripheral. Manual instructions distinguish simple selections from held-button dragging used by other tools, so the whole program is not hold-free. Many icons and palette choices can create menu clutter. The separate Gnat Attack activity adds reaction demands and is outside this suggested stamp-and-fill trial. This is creation, not a character-story adventure.

**Try this first.** Choose one stamp and one fill color, then make a small picture. Leave freehand dragging, animation and the reaction minigame aside while checking mouse comfort.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

## P154 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

# Mario Paint

**AIDEN AFTER HOURS / The Hotel Let Me Design the Welcome Screen Once**

They gave me a drawing station for the party's welcome display. I selected a stamp, filled a color, and discovered a level of creative power the hotel had foolishly left unsupervised.

Shawna watched my first design. 'Nigga, why your name on it fourteen times?'

'Visual rhythm.'

Mercedes removed thirteen. Suddenly the picture looked better. I called this collaboration and kept my original invoice.

Dre chose a blue background and said his casserole deserved equal billing. Tank stamped a little shape near the buffet arrow. Rosa wanted a flower, not another slogan.

We made something ridiculous together. Nobody asked whether it belonged in a gallery. The small act was enough.

Then I found the separate reaction game and started boasting. Shawna turned back to the picture.

'Different activity, baby. You were enjoying this one.'

I stayed with the stamps.

Tank nodded at the finished screen. 'Nigga finally left a little space for the guests.'

**Aiden's verdict.** Try stamps and fills if playful creation appeals. The original mouse setup and other tools' dragging remain distinct from this narrow invitation, which excludes the reaction minigame.

**Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026**

Nintendo announcement confirms the 1992 original; original Nintendo manual transcription, hosted by a third party, distinguishes stamps/fills from held dragging and the separate Gnat Attack activity. Card scope is original SNES Mouse play, not an automatic claim about modern ports.

Source 1: <https://www.nintendo.com/us/whatsnew/mario-paint-scribbles-into-the-super-nes-collection/>

Source 2: <https://manualzz.com/doc/26101036/nintendo-mario-paint-family-user-manual>

## P155 / A MORE DEMANDING DETOUR

# Color a Dinosaur

Edition considered: 1993 NES original

**Revisit an unusual NES coloring toy if choosing colors for simple pictures is exactly the small retro activity you want.**

**What you do.** Select a picture, choose colors and fill a few regions, trying the manual's narrow point-to-point coloring arrangement first.

Direction + buttons | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

**Main catch.** Its child-oriented style and limited variety may rule it out; full timing and modern-device behavior remain untested.

**Why it might click.** Color a Dinosaur is an original NES coloring toy with a deliberately small activity loop. Its manual describes selecting pictures and filling regions with colors, including a point-to-point control arrangement. It belongs here as a specific retro curiosity for someone who wants that simple action, not as a substitute for adult narrative.

**The full catch.** The presentation is aimed at young children and the variety is limited. That may be a taste veto regardless of how few controls are needed. The original manual supports the coloring controls, while full-play timing and modern-device behavior have not been tested here. Mode changes can affect the drawing; check the intended setup rather than assuming an emulator reproduces every behavior conveniently.

**Try this first.** If the retro coloring idea itself appeals, fill a few regions in one picture. Stop the trial once its narrow appeal is clear; completing a picture is optional.

## AIDEN AFTER HOURS / The Dinosaur Wasn't Applying for an Adult Drama Award

The retro table had a dinosaur picture waiting for color. I announced that we could reframe it as a sophisticated meditation on extinction.

Mercedes looked at the picture. 'Nigga, it wants green.'

Dre chose blue. Tank said the dinosaur now owed the casserole table a visit. Shawna filled another region because she liked the color, not because I had finally explained art.

It was a small old toy. That could be fun for the person who wanted a small old toy. I did not need to dress it in a tuxedo and promise a complicated love affair.

Rosa tried one region, smiled, then went back to her song. Nobody made her stay.

I prepared another ambitious interpretation. My wife handed me the controller.

'Pick a color, baby.' I picked an outrageous one.

Tank leaned over. 'There. Nigga discovered taste without writing a grant.'

The dinosaur remained exactly as simple as it had been. The evening survived this honest description.

**Aiden's verdict.** Visit only if the retro coloring toy itself appeals. Its narrow loop and child-oriented presentation are real limits, regardless of how grandly I introduce the dinosaur.

## Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026

Original manual scan, hosted by a third party, was visually examined in the earlier project research (work/retro-games.json); current reopen yielded no searchable text. Manual-supported point-to-point coloring is a narrow option, not a tested whole-game or emulator guarantee. Wrong Steam coloring-game match excluded.

Source 1: <https://www.digitpress.com/library/manuals/nes/Color%20a%20Dinosaur.pdf>

P156 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

# The Incredible Machine 3

Edition considered: 1995 Windows original

**Revisit a historical contraption puzzle if making an unlikely chain of cause and effect succeed is the attraction you remember.**

**What you do.** On an existing working setup, inspect an introductory contraption and change one component to observe the resulting chain of effects.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Co-op details need checking

**Main catch.** Primary mechanics verification, exact controls, current availability and compatibility remain unresolved; setup could overwhelm the intended evening.

**Why it might click.** The Incredible Machine 3 is a historical contraption-building puzzle candidate: arrange parts into chains of cause and effect to achieve an objective. Its appeal is seeing an unlikely mechanism succeed after a useful adjustment. This 1995 Windows entry is included for a revisit if an existing copy and workable setup are available.

**The full catch.** Evidence is weaker here than for the modern store entries. A Sierra historical archive identifies the game, but its descriptive text credits a secondary database; the linked scanned manual was located without usable text verification. Exact mouse actions, timers, compatibility and present availability remain unresolved. Do not mistake this historical candidate for a certified easy-to-run or hold-free recommendation.

**Try this first.** On a working existing setup, inspect one introductory contraption and its controls before changing a single component. Avoid turning software setup into the evening's main activity.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

## P156 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

# The Incredible Machine 3

**AIDEN AFTER HOURS / The Machine Rang a Bell to Tell Me I Was an Idiot**

I built a table arrangement intended to ring a bell when the first guest sat down. The manager asked why I couldn't greet the guest normally.

'Nigga, scale.'

Tank inspected the ball, the little track, and the expensive object I'd used as a support. 'Your scale has my dessert plate.'

Shawna moved one part. Nothing happened. Mercedes moved another. The ball finally travelled, nudged the next piece, and produced a tiny bright ring.

I grinned before I could announce what the grin meant. Ridiculous chain. Real result. That was the pleasure.

Then Rosa sat down and the whole thing rang again. Tank sat. Again. Every arriving adult received the same stupid welcome.

By the sixth ring, even I understood the manager's question.

Shawna took the ball away. 'Successful experiment, baby.' 'Why stop it?' 'Because we learned what it does.'

Tank reclaimed his plate. 'Nigga invented a bell and then discovered dinner needed silence.'

**Aiden's verdict.** Keep the historical contraption builder for a working existing setup. Its mechanical idea is attractive, but control details and current compatibility remain explicitly unverified in this research.

**Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026**

Explicit source gap: historical Sierra archive page inspected, but its descriptive prose credits MobyGames. Original scanned manual located, not successfully read for mechanics in this pass. Primary identity locator is available; detailed controls, timing, current availability and compatibility remain unverified.

Source 1: <https://www.sierragamers.com/tim-3/>

Source 2: [https://www.sierragamers.com/wp-content/uploads/2019/12/TIM\\_3\\_Manual.pdf](https://www.sierragamers.com/wp-content/uploads/2019/12/TIM_3_Manual.pdf)

P157 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

# SimCity 2000 Special Edition

Edition considered: PC Special Edition

**Build and manage a classic city if planning how its parts support one another sounds as interesting as watching the skyline grow.**

**What you do.** Inspect a city, use its building and service tools and respond to the relationships between the settlement's needs.

Mouse / pointer | Some real-time demands | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

**Main catch.** Budgets, services, simulation behavior and old menus add substantial complexity; pause behavior and no-pressure modes were not verified.

**Why it might click.** SimCity 2000 Special Edition offers the classic city-building and management fantasy, with the ability to design a settlement and respond to its needs. The current exact-edition store description includes additional cities and scenarios. It may appeal through nostalgia, long-term planning and the satisfaction of a place taking shape.

**The full catch.** Management brings budgets, services, tools and simulation behavior into the same interface. This is a meaningful increase in menu and system complexity, not a default low-demand choice. Check speed controls, pausing, the ability to inspect while paused and the readability of the old interface on the intended setup. The reviewed sources do not establish a special no-pressure mode or hold-free operation.

**Try this first.** Inspect an existing city or an introductory situation and identify one service before building extensively. Decide whether managing relationships between systems sounds enjoyable, rather than merely liking the skyline.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

## P157 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

# SimCity 2000 Special Edition

**AIDEN AFTER HOURS / The Mayor Put the Strip Club Where the Water Should Go**

I arranged the casino's miniature city display into what I called a vision of prosperity. Nightlife first. Magnificent skyline. A private road to my house.

Shawna looked at the empty corner. 'Where the water?' 'In the champagne.'

Tank stopped me. 'Nigga, the citizens need to wash.'

Mercedes moved a model building and asked where ordinary people would live. Rosa wanted a neighborhood that didn't hear my opening ceremony every night. Dre put his tiny blue car somewhere with parking.

The city became interesting when it had needs beyond admiring me. A system could answer a foolish choice with a problem I had to understand.

I liked that possibility. I also saw how much attention it could demand. A whole city would not become simple because its buildings looked cute from above.

My wife moved the private road out of the way.

'There,' she said. 'Now your constituents can reach something useful.'

Tank pointed at the water. 'Democracy got a shower, nigga.'

**Aiden's verdict.** Choose the city only if managing linked systems is appealing. Budgets, menus and simulation behavior are central; the attractive skyline does not turn it into a simple decorating toy.

**Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026**

Exact Special Edition GOG listing and official EA title page inspected. Supports city design/management and edition identity; pause behavior, no-pressure modes and present-device control comfort were not verified.

Source 1: [https://www.gog.com/en/game/simcity\\_2000\\_special\\_edition](https://www.gog.com/en/game/simcity_2000_special_edition)

Source 2: <https://www.ea.com/games/simcity/simcity-2000>

P158 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

# RollerCoaster Tycoon Deluxe

Edition considered: PC Deluxe edition

**Design a familiar little amusement park if caring about its visitors and finances is part of the attraction alongside building rides.**

**What you do.** Place or inspect attractions, arrange the park and manage the guest needs and finances surrounding its operation over time.

Mouse / pointer | Some real-time demands | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

**Main catch.** Menus, money and scenario demands can create pressure; prebuilt rides do not remove the wider management system.

**Why it might click.** RollerCoaster Tycoon Deluxe combines the original park-management game with its two expansion packs. It offers both custom coaster construction and prebuilt rides, alongside the business of keeping guests and finances in order. The pleasure can be a recognizable little park evolving through practical and creative decisions.

**The full catch.** Designing rides is only part of the game: management menus, guest needs, money and scenario demands can create pressure. Check simulation speed and pause behavior, exact mouse operations and interface size. The presence of prebuilt rides does not remove the rest of the management system, and this edition should not be credited with modes from later RollerCoaster Tycoon releases.

**Try this first.** Inspect an opening park or scenario and locate one prebuilt attraction in the interface. Evaluate whether the management surrounding construction feels interesting before committing to a large custom coaster.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

## P158 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

# RollerCoaster Tycoon Deluxe

**AIDEN AFTER HOURS / The Queue for My Grand Opening Had Formed Outside the Wrong Ride**

I opened the party's miniature amusement area with a speech long enough to create its own waiting line. Tank stood at the back eating popcorn.

'Nigga, the ride is leaving before you finish.'

Shawna pointed at a perfectly good prebuilt attraction. Mercedes wanted to try it. Rosa wanted the music turned down near the seating. The guests kept having actual preferences while I described my vision.

I looked across the little park layout. Paths mattered. Where something sat mattered. A beautiful idea could still send everybody to the same cramped corner.

Porsche moved a sign, and the queue split sensibly. More practical improvement than my last three paragraphs combined.

I handed the microphone to the attendant.

Tank applauded immediately. 'Best opening you ever done.'

My wife took my hand and led me toward the ride. 'You coming?'

I went. A man could enjoy his own party once he stopped trying to stand in front of every fucking entrance.

**Aiden's verdict.** Try the park if design and management both sound enjoyable. Prebuilt rides ease one task, while guest needs, money and scenario pressure remain part of the game.

**Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026**

Exact-title developer/publisher Steam description inspected for premise and edition. Fit and first trial are editorial suggestions. Controls, timing and comfort remain bounded by the explicit checks in the card; no complete playthrough performed.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/285310/>

P159 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

# Theme Hospital

Edition considered: 1997 PC original

**Run a satirical institution if exaggerated operational problems and resource management sound entertaining, rather than looking for a personal character adventure.**

**What you do.** Design and maintain the hospital, manage its staff and rooms and balance the resources needed to keep it operating.

Mouse / pointer | Some real-time demands | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

**Main catch.** Busy menus and simulation pressure need checking, while fictional illnesses and death may make the subject unwelcome.

**Why it might click.** Bullfrog's original Theme Hospital is a comic management game about designing and running an institution with limited resources. The official EA page emphasizes building, maintaining and managing the hospital while balancing cash and its exaggerated fictional problems. Its appeal is institutional satire and operational tinkering, rather than a rich personal adventure.

**The full catch.** Staff, rooms, resources and developing demands can make this a busy management choice. Its comic visual style does not remove time pressure or menu work. Check pausing, speed behavior, readable text and the exact mouse controls before assuming a relaxed setup is possible. The humor includes exaggerated illnesses and death, which may simply be the wrong subject for an enjoyable evening.

**Try this first.** Inspect the early building and management interface without committing to an elaborate plan. Decide whether its subject and overlapping responsibilities are appealing before taking on the continuing simulation.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

## P159 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

# Theme Hospital

**AIDEN AFTER HOURS / The Administrator Bought Marble Before Buying Chairs**

I spent the lounge's comfort budget on a marble reception desk. It looked magnificent. Every guest then had to stand while admiring it.

Rosa put her bag down. 'Nigga, where do people sit?'

I gestured toward the desk as if beauty might support a human ass. Shawna gave me the look she reserved for expensive ideas with missing middle steps.

Tank brought chairs from the adjoining room. Mercedes put the service menu where people could read it. Porsche found the attendant I'd stationed behind a decorative curtain.

Within five minutes the place worked better and looked less like my fantasy of institutional power.

The hospital-management satire on the game table suddenly seemed to have me in its sights. Rooms. Staff. Money. Consequences. A building did not run on the administrator's posture.

I offered to help move another chair.

Dre watched me carry it. 'Look at this nigga. Community service with cufflinks.'

Shawna kissed my cheek. I made a note to invest in more useful furniture.

**Aiden's verdict.** Choose the institutional satire only if its subject and management workload appeal. Busy systems and potentially pressuring simulation remain real catches beneath the exaggerated comic presentation.

**Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026**

Official EA page identifies Bullfrog's original 1997 Theme Hospital and building/management with limited resources. The automatic Steam hit was unrelated DLC and is excluded. Exact pause/hold behavior remains to be checked.

Source 1: <https://www.ea.com/games/theme/theme-hospital>

## P160 / READ THE CATCH FIRST

# Zoombinis

Edition considered: 2015 PC remake of Logical Journey of the Zoombinis

**Guide familiar blue travelers through a cartoon logic journey if its particular nostalgia and pattern-discovery charm are what you want tonight.**

**What you do.** Try the remake's puzzle types, notice patterns and make choices that help the travelers continue toward their new home.

Mouse / pointer | Timing needs checking | Single-player; a friend can share the decisions

**Main catch.** The child-oriented style is a real taste limit; difficulty, dragging, penalties and timing require puzzle-specific checks.

**Why it might click.** This is the 2015 remake of Logical Journey of the Zoombinis, a cartoon adventure built around pattern and logic puzzles. The developer describes twelve puzzle types with several difficulty levels as the travellers seek a new home. It may appeal through nostalgic character, rule discovery and a sequence of distinct reasoning tasks.

**The full catch.** The child-oriented presentation is a real taste consideration, especially when the desired experience is a grown-up character story. Logic difficulty can increase independently of that appearance. Check the specific puzzle's clicking, dragging, penalties and timing; the store description does not establish a universally untimed or hold-free route. This entry refers to the remake, not every older edition or platform version.

**Try this first.** Try one early puzzle and explain the pattern you think matters. Check whether helping these characters feels charming before investing in harder levels or the larger journey.

Aiden's complete scene and the source notes follow on the next page.

## P160 / THE COMIC SCENE AND SOURCES

# Zoombinis

**AIDEN AFTER HOURS / The Travellers Did Not Need My Nightclub Dress Code**

I arranged the little blue figures on the retro table into a VIP line. Tank looked at the shapes. 'Nigga, you denying entry to a cartoon?'

I said a journey required standards. Shawna moved the velvet ribbon I'd borrowed and let everybody see the actual puzzle.

Dre pointed at the blue group. 'These my cousins now. Treat them right.'

Mercedes asked what pattern mattered. Rosa noticed a difference between two figures. The conversation became useful once I stopped inventing social status for the pieces.

The old cartoon adventure had its own charm. Somebody could enjoy that without being talked down to, or decline it without having to prove adulthood to me.

I tried the next choice and watched what changed.

Shawna smiled. 'There you go.' 'Natural leadership.'

Tank shook his head. 'Nigga, you just stopped blocking the road.'

We let the travellers continue. I kept the ribbon for a more appropriate purpose: stopping Darnell from pitching his yacht to the band again.

**Aiden's verdict.** Try the remake if its particular cartoon logic journey appeals. Pattern difficulty and puzzle-specific controls still need checking; nostalgia should invite a visit rather than demand one.

**Evidence desk / checked 20 September 2026**

Exact-title developer/publisher Steam description inspected for premise and edition. Fit and first trial are editorial suggestions. Controls, timing and comfort remain bounded by the explicit checks in the card; no complete playthrough performed.

Source 1: <https://store.steampowered.com/app/397430/>

## The Cork Had Been Available Separately

The ordinary bottle opened with one clean sound. Every head turned, including the host's. Tank lifted his glass toward the elaborate locked box. 'Hear that, motherfucker? Your competition.' The host laughed, finally abandoning the expensive solemnity he'd been issued with his waistcoat.

We had solved some things and left other things alone. A few games had become more inviting when their actions were stated plainly. Others had revealed a catch that settled the matter just as usefully. Nobody earned extra status by choosing the hardest board. Nobody had to accept dragging, camera movement or timed action because the room liked the joke printed beside it. The games kept their real demands. We kept the right to choose.

Mercedes and Darnell finished the little picture arrangement. He smiled without looking around to see who had noticed. Rosa tried another mechanical detail before putting it down. Dre retrieved the blue controller from under a napkin and asked who wanted it next. Tank collected the empty plates with an efficiency that suggested we had been wasting a talented nigga on speeches.

The host offered us a final attempt at the carved box. I looked at Shawna. She looked at the ordinary champagne, then at the suite key in my hand. 'What do you actually want to do?' The question had become dangerously effective.

I wanted to understand the box eventually. Tonight I wanted to leave with my wife while she was still smiling at the man inside the ridiculous suit. I told the host we would let the mechanism retain its dignity until another visit. He handed me a small card describing its maker. A good invitation. No challenge attached.

At the elevator, Tank asked whether I'd enjoyed the intellectual experience. 'Nigga, I learned plenty.' Shawna pressed our floor. 'He learned the cork was available separately.' Mercedes laughed from the table. Dre raised the casserole dish in farewell. Darnell opened his mouth, saw the closing doors, and mercifully saved the yacht for somebody else's tomorrow.

Upstairs my wife took the key, opened the room in one uncomplicated movement and looked back at me. 'See? This one works.' I followed her inside with the bottle. Whatever happened after that required no narrator, no leaderboard, and absolutely no motherfucking puzzle box.

## Credits, source limits and the paperwork we actually mean

Creative direction: Nolan. The Tellings Cut: original revised Panorama prose and production by ChatGPT; original game research and selection system retained. This is a separate adult comic companion to Ten Toes Down. Source novels and the first Panorama edition remain intact. All people participating in the fictional party scenes are adults; Lillian is addressed as the reader.

Voice sources sampled for this revision: the Niggatorial Tellings Book I funeral and first Vegas party, selected passages from Books II-VI, and the edition editorial record. Source repository Sodelin/Ten-Toes-Down; working base 4cdof7a6e36977ff0ac705a59ebe65407d1f2bee. Selected passages were read closely; no full reread of all six novels is claimed. The added game-night story is newly composed fiction.

The optional traits, tokens and signed-dice layer take inspiration from Fate. The Panorama's catalogue coordinates, vetoes, snack amendment, incidents and appeals are original comic selection rules; this is not a substitute for the Fate rulebooks.

Fate reference pages consulted:

<https://fate-srd.com/fate-accelerated/how-do-stuff-outcomes-actions-and-approaches> and <https://fate-srd.com/fate-accelerated/aspects-fate-points>. No Fate logos, illustrations or fonts are used.

This work is based on Fate Core System and Fate Accelerated Edition, products of Evil Hat Productions, LLC, developed, authored, and edited by Leonard Balsera, Brian Engard, Jeremy Keller, Ryan Macklin, Mike Olson, Clark Valentine, Amanda Valentine, Fred Hicks, and Rob Donoghue, and licensed for our use under the Creative Commons Attribution 3.0 Unported license (<https://creativecommons.org/licenses/by/3.0/>).

Game titles identify the corresponding games. No game code, ROMs, full manuals or third-party artwork are included. Availability and controls can vary by edition, region and platform. The sources support their stated claims; no purchase, installation or personal fit has been established by this book.

This adult comic edition includes frequent reclaimed in-group language, strong profanity, fictional cocaine and party references, sexual banter and non-graphic innuendo. Those scenes are separate from the factual game descriptions and are not descriptions of the developers or real readers.

Each case names its inspected sources and the limits of those sources. Store descriptions and developer feature declarations are not a playthrough of every route. The companion evidence ledger records editorial tags separately from source declarations. Availability and features may change after the check date.